**Final Report**

BSHES 524: Community Assessment
December 15, 2025

Madison Benjamin, Sofia Charlot, Jason Goliath,
Amy Hunt, Victoria Ostebo, Mia Williams

## Table of Contents

## Executive Summary

Physical activity is fundamental to community health and wellness, and universities serve as hubs for promoting fitness and wellness within their campuses and the broader community. Regular physical activity lowers the risk of chronic diseases such as obesity, diabetes, and cardiovascular disease- while improving mental health outcomes like stress management and social connectedness. (Zou, Liu, Guo, Zhao, & Cai, 2023). At Emory University, the campus gym offers a range of individual fitness and group fitness classes and activities designed to encourage exercise, social connection, and healthy lifestyles. Group fitness classes are associated with higher rates of adherence to exercise routines due to the built-in accountability and peer support (Zou et al. 2023). Therefore, assessing engagement with group fitness classes is more than just a measure of recreational interest; it is an examination of how well Emory Recreation and Wellness (RecWell) fosters long-term health and wellness among its members.

The population of interest for this community assessment includes the diverse groups who utilize the Emory University gym. While undergraduate and graduate students make up a significant portion of the gym's population, community members also engage with these programs, making the gym a unique space where diverse populations come together. For Emory University's gym, facilities are available as a portion of the student wellness package for both undergraduate and graduate students (Emory University Recreation & Wellness, 2017). However, a large number of faculty, staff, and the greater Decatur community participate through paid memberships. This creates a unique environment where individuals with different schedules, priorities, and health needs share the same facilities. Non-student members, who are the central focus of this assessment, may engage differently than students due to factors such as work demands, schedule differences, family responsibilities, or financial investment in their membership. Understanding how this population utilizes gym offerings is critical for tailoring fitness programming that meets the needs of both students and the broader community.

The following questions guided this CA:

1. What are the unmet needs of those who utilize Emory Recreation and Wellness?
2. What barriers exist to utilizing Emory Recreation and Wellness?
3. What are the key similarities and differences between students' usage and non-student member usage?
4. What are the gaps in awareness and utilization of Emory Recreation and Wellness resources?

The data for this CA was collected from September 2025 to October 2025 using mixed-methods approach. The secondary data consisted of a literary review examining past data challenges and methods of collection of gym activities, benefits of using recreational facilities and challenges relating to awareness. Primary data consisted of two windshield surveys observing the recreational facilities, three key informant interviews with RecWell staff, and an online survey distributed to student and non-student members (n=300). The quantitative data was cleaned and analyzed through descriptive statistics and comparative analysis while qualitative data was reviewed thematically.

Thematic analysis revealed multiple key strengths and challenges related to the RecWell facilities. The main challenges reported were related to gaps in communication and awareness to student and non-student as well as structural limitations that restricted facility capacity and offerings. The interviews also emphasize the positive role of RecWell in its contribution to boost physical and mental health for its users. Overall, the insight helped shape an understanding of constraints that affected day-to-day use and highlighted opportunities to improve engagement and accessibility.

Through triangulation of data sources, the CA group outlined six major findings: 1) facility access & availability issues, 2) low awareness of recreational resources & group fitness opportunities, 3) lack of equipment in rotation, 4) financial barriers to usage of facilities and resources, 5) feeling unwelcome or intimidated in facility spaces and 6) activity preferences differ substantially by member type.

Based on the key findings that were presented, the CA team developed a list of recommendations for Emory RecWell. These recommendations consisted of:

1. Expanding gym hours based on staffing and budgeting constraints.
2. Improving facility cleanliness and locker room updates based on high feasibility.
3. Updating equipment rotation schedules to ensure a wider and more reliable range of fitness options.
4. Creating more welcoming and inclusive environments through staff training and community-building initiatives.
5. Offering diverse group fitness classes that reflect the varied preferences and needs of students, faculty, staff, and community members.
6. Tailoring programming based on member type.

The results of this assessment will be valuable not only for identifying current levels of participation but also for guiding improvements in programming and facility use. If specific populations, such as faculty or community members, show lower participation, targeted outreach or other incentives can be developed to increase engagement. In this way, the assessment will serve as both a descriptive tool and a roadmap for enhancing the overall recreation and wellness experience at Emory.

## Background

### Community Assessment Purpose

The purpose of this community assessment is to gain a deeper understanding of the patterns of participation in group fitness classes among student and non-student members of Emory Recreation and Wellness facilities. Non- student members include Emory faculty and staff, Emory alumni, Emory affiliates, Emory family members, and community members. By examining the frequency of class attendance, the types of classes most utilized, and areas where improvements could be made, this assessment will provide insight into how the gym can continue to serve as a hub of wellness. Ultimately, the purpose is not only to describe current use but also to generate actionable recommendations that support both individual health and community well-being.

### Community Partner Organization

Rollins graduate students conducted this community assessment in partnership with the Emory Recreation and Wellness committee. Emory's Recreation and Wellness committee is committed to fostering a standard of excellence through innovation in collegiate athletics, and recreation plays a central role in shaping the culture of health and fitness at Emory University.

The department has a history of fostering student development and community engagement through recreational programming, intramural sports, fitness services, and wellness initiatives (Emory University Recreation & Wellness, 2017). Its mission emphasizes equipping and empowering individuals for success in sport, health, and overall well-being in the Emory and Decatur community. Through values such as inclusion, accountability, and leadership, the organization seeks to create a supportive and motivating environment for all members of the gym community (Emory University Recreation & Wellness, 2017). By partnering with this organization, the community assessment ensures that findings will directly inform future decisions around group fitness offerings, resource allocation, and member engagement strategies.

## Literature Review

University fitness and recreational facilities are a core aspect of a campus, influencing wellness, academic success, community, and even recruitment for students and members (Phipps et al., 2015; Forrester et al.,2015; Kampf et al., 2018; Vasold et al., 2021). While central to wellbeing, many facilities are unable to accurately record aspects of facility usage and how to promote awareness of their offerings to varying populations. Past research indicates the importance of examining both factors as a means of informing strategies and increasing overall facility usage and health efforts. This literature review will synthesize research on facility data collection methods and awareness strategies, aimed at promoting increased facility engagement.

### ***Benefits of Facility Usage***

Many studies support the positive effect of working out and attending recreational facilities, especially among university students. It has been shown that students who attend the gym more regularly are not only likely to have a higher retention rate but will also do better in school (Mayers et al., 2017; Zegre et al., 2020). According to Zegre et al. (2020), first year students who regularly used their universities recreational facilities had a 7-8% higher retention rate compared to their peers who did not use the campus facilities. Among first year students 84.5% to 91.7% reported that student recreational facilities had some level of importance in their decision to attend the facility and 89.4% to 92.5% of students reported that it had some level of importance in their retention (Kampf et al., 2018).

Another study, based on NSSE data, found that increased recreational facility use was not only tied to academic success but also to overall engagement (Mayers et al., 2017). These students were more likely to initiate faculty-student interaction, participate in active learning, and enrich their overall education experience (Mayers et al., 2017).

Intermural sports are another large part of athletic facilities and have proven to create a myriad of positive outcomes. Participants of intermural sports found themselves gaining time management skills, teamwork capabilities, and campus connection (Wilson & Millar, 2021). Participation was also found to increase connection, belonging, and a sense of community (Phipps et al., 2015).

While positive outcomes associated with recreational facility usage on campus are well documented for students, these health benefits extend to all users beyond the student population. Both the CDC and WHO recommend engaging in 150 minutes of moderate physical activity per week to prevent chronic illnesses such as heart disease, diabetes as well as strengthening the body against infectious disease (CDC, 2024; WHO, 2024). Regular physical activity is also proven to reduce anxiety, stress, and depression while increasing sleep quality (WHO, 2024).

These health, mental, and physical benefits underscore the importance of continued facility research centering on both students and users. However, without functional tracking systems in place, it is difficult to improve systems in a manner that is tailored to and responsive to user experiences and needs. More efficient data collection combined with targeted awareness strategies can inform on how to support the facilities' users and maximize all of the associated benefits of participating.

### *Facility Data Collection Challenges*

One major challenge recreational facilities face is accurately collecting data usage after individuals enter the facility. Traditional metrics for facility data collection are centered around entrance, exit, and registration data. While indicative of the overall quantity of users, these metrics lack a holistic vision in assessing user behaviors (Zegre et al., 2020). After an initial swipe in, facilities are unable to target what people do once inside the facilities. Therefore, they are unable to critically assess high-volume areas, classes, or activities, and where to make expansions or changes to gym operations. For example, students might only enter the facility to use amenities such as the bathroom or study areas, inflating entry counts. This disconnect could lead to a decrease in participation, as users feel the facilities are out of touch with their needs. Research shows that social and environmental factors strongly shape overall user experience (Riseth et al., 2019). As a result of these limitations, research has sought to expand data collection methods to include more meaningful data inside facilities.

### *Facility Data Collection Methods*

While traditional metrics can be limiting, advancements in technology have opened the door to new ways of monitoring activity within fitness and recreational areas. Nike Training Club, Strava, and MyFitnessPal are all popular training apps, designed to capture personal workout metrics and help plan workouts. While apps are useful, there is an associated cost of having to enter your data to show progress. Many fitness watches can track exercise patterns and energy expenditure, but users often have to input the machines they use to accurately track their data. Some gyms have found a solution to this problem. Using an Internet of Things (IoT) approach, a study assessed the validity of an automated system to measure machinery usage (Bian et al., 2023). The study’s prototype system attached beacons with embedded inertial measurement units (IMUs). These sensors automatically monitored usage and sent collected data to users and facility operators through Bluetooth and Wi-Fi systems (Bian et al., 2023). Their field test indicated a 94.6% accuracy rate of gym users' activities, and with improved beacon placement is believed to achieve even greater accuracy (Bian et al., 2023). This initiative was low-cost, low-energy consumption, and supported the privacy of the users (Bian et al., 2023). Not only are users allowed to fully focus on their workout, but the system also provides insights into gym operations, such as crowd monitoring and popular machinery, which can guide resource allocation.

Another solution that requires no user input is the use of wearable recognition setups such as Myzone Belts or Zephyr BioHarness 3. Once put on, the Myzone belt projects calories used, heart rate, time, and effort points (Pedragosa et al., 2022). Users have the option of sharing their data with the facility and choosing to have their efforts displayed on screens (Pedragosa et al., 2022). Although this tool does not provide analytics of machine-specific usage, it effectively measures duration, intensity, and consistency of use. Hussein et al, utilized a BioHarness in combination with LSTM models to recognize 42 exercises with 82%-91% accuracy (Hussain et al., 2022). This data, similarly to the Myzone system, could be updated to the operator dashboard, providing an oversight of facility usage.

While quantitative methods can capture user swipes and machinery usage, they can still leave large gaps in understanding the motivations and barriers of facility usage. For this reason, investing in human resources and organizational approaches can be beneficial to goals related to increased usage and awareness (Wilson et al., 2022). Research demonstrates the value of qualitative and mixed methods approaches to gain a more comprehensive understanding of members' motivation, challenges, and usage patterns (Rapport et al., 2018; Riseth et al., 2019). A study conducted by Rapport et al centered their survey and research around facility observations and let the users inform their recommendations. Their results showed that facility spaces were often gendered, multifunctional, used for stress relief, and sometimes intimidating (Rapport et al., 2018). Rieth et al. (2019) found that social and environmental support is a key contributor to long-term engagement at facilities and places importance on factors like facility cleanliness and staff friendliness. Qualitative analysis captures general data but also subtleties into what creates a welcoming environment that one wants to return to. Such approaches can inform awareness strategies to further promote facility resources and events.

### *Increasing Awareness*

In considering potential influences on student usage of recreational facilities, a prevailing barrier is a lack of awareness. (Ersöz et al., 2023; Young et al., 2003). In a study assessing constraints that students face pertaining to recreational activity, one of the primary barriers to access was a lack of knowledge or awareness of what was available to the student population. (Young et al., 2003). As a result, students are unlikely to utilize facilities beyond what is readily available; specifically, a lack of awareness resulted in an absence of participation in recreational activities (Young et al., 2003). In increasing understanding of the resources provided by campus recreation, as well as the benefits of staying active, students are more likely to engage in activities (Mayers et al., 2017; Young et al., 2003).

As previously mentioned, usage of the gym and other recreational facilities has been seen to improve overall student performance in academic settings (Mayers et al., 2017). While this may act as an incentive for students to remain active, many are unaware of the academic benefit associated with consistent recreational activity (Mayers et al., 2017). Furthermore, it has been seen that students who are cognizant of the positive impact staying active can have on physical, mental, and emotional well-being are more likely to utilize the gym and prioritize fitness activities over those who are not aware of such benefits (Ersöz et al., 2023). As such, in pursuit of increasing utilization of recreational facilities, stakeholders must improve information dissemination for student populations.

In the wake of social media and the permeation of the internet, day-to-day interactions have become largely influenced by what is seen and understood on online platforms (Alfred, 2025; Kim et al., 2016). It has been clearly documented that digital resources play a significant role in improving access to knowledge through infographics, sharing amongst social circles, and more streamlined methods of finding and identifying information (Alfred, 2025). In addition to this, Alfred (2025) found that digital resources have the capacity to greatly shape how student populations make decisions. It can be assumed, with this knowledge, that increasing the quantity and spread of digital resources posted by institutional recreational entities can positively influence students' behaviors regarding the gym. This is, in part, due to how students share posts and activities they are interested in or participating in. One of the primary reasons that social media is effective in increasing participation is that students utilize social media as their main means of communication, resulting in event information being shared efficiently and effectively in a streamlined manner (Fraccastoro et al., 2020). This also results in more connectivity being established between students through online platforms instead of in-person interactions (Fraccastoro et al., 2020).

It has been noted that students view social media as an instrument for connection, highlighting the potential impact of online resources on increasing recreational activity (Fraccastoro et al., 2020). Because students desire connection and cultivation of relationships through social media, they are more likely to engage in activities that are shared by friends or influential groups on campus (Fraccastoro et al., 2020). By utilizing online platforms to disseminate information about recreational activities and encouraging students to share such information, engagement in facilities is likely to increase.

Though social media plays a large role in influencing student populations, it is not realistic to assume that every student engages with and values the internet as a means of connection and obtaining information. A study conducted by Fraccastoro et al. (2020) found that students prefer communication from their academic institutions to be facilitated through email (57.2% of respondents), followed by informational posts on Instagram (39.7% of respondents). Knowing this, recreational facilities might cater to student populations by creating both social media posts and informational emails to be distributed to the affiliated student body. In doing so, it can be ensured that more students are reached through their most preferred methods of communication and that information regarding the benefits of physical activity, opportunities to engage in recreational events, and resources available at campus recreational facilities is more widely distributed across the population.

#### *Conclusion*

The literature makes clear that university fitness and recreational facilities play a significant role in promoting student health, academic success, and campus connection. However, the evaluation of their effectiveness is limited by challenges in accurately tracking facility use and ensuring awareness of available resources. Emerging technologies such as wearable devices and IoT systems offer promising opportunities to gather more meaningful usage data, while qualitative methods highlight the importance of user perspectives in shaping welcoming, inclusive spaces. At the same time, lack of awareness remains a key barrier to engagement, suggesting that communication strategies are essential to increasing participation, and are most effective when facilitated through digital platforms and institutional emails. Overall, evidence supports that improved data collection combined with targeted outreach can strengthen facility operations and better serve the diverse needs of the campus community.

## Community Profile

### *Community Description*

Emory University's main campus is in a suburban neighborhood called Druid Hills, situated northeast of the city center, with downtown and Midtown just 15-minute drives away. The campus is connected to Atlanta's transit system, MARTA, primarily via buses, as there are no train stations on or near campus. (Office of Undergraduate Admission, n.d.). The Druid Hills neighborhood is in DeKalb County, and DeKalb County is a part of the Metro Atlanta area (ARC, n.d.). According to Emory's Office of Planning and Administration, there were about 16,000 students enrolled at Emory University in the 2024 fall semester. Across all ten schools that make up this institution, approximately 14,600 students were enrolled full-time, and 15,500 were seeking degrees. More than half of the student body were undergraduates (52%), with the remaining proportion enrolled as postgraduate students. Domestic students made up 82% of enrollment, while international students made up approximately 18% (See Table 1) (Office of Institutional Research and Decision Support, n.d.).

| Table 1: Academic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs | |
|---|---|
| **Degree-Seeking status** | |
| Degree | 15,494 (96.0%) |
| Non-Degree | 648 (4.0%) |
| **Academic Career** | |
| Undergraduate | 8,374 (51.9%) |
| Postgraduate | 7,768 (48.1%) |
| **Academic Load** | |
| Full-Time | 14,610 (90.5%) |
| Part-Time | 1,532 (9.5%) |
| **Residency** | |
| Domestic | 13,212 (81.8%) |
| International | 2,930 (18.2%) |
| **School** | |
| Allied Health Programs | 534 (3.3%) |
| Candler School of Theology | 422 (2.6%) |
| Emory College of Arts & Sciences | 5,567 (34.5%) |
| Goizueta Business School | 2,319 (14.4%) |
| Laney Graduate School | 2,092 (13.0%) |
| Nell Hodgson Woodruff School of Nursing | 1,393 (8.6%) |
| Oxford College | 967 (6.0%) |
| Rollins School of Public Health | 977 (6.1%) |
| School of Law | 839 (5.2%) |
| School of Medicine | 1,032 (6.4%) |

*Figure A1: Academic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs.*

Emory's student population was majority female (60%), and students were mostly between the ages of 18 and 24 (64%). Within the domestic student population, the largest racial or ethnic group was White (32%), followed by Asian (20%), Black (14%), and Hispanic (10%). This population includes a small proportion of students within the Native American or Alaska Native, Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander, and Two or More Races categories. 56% of enrolled students identified as first generation, which is defined as a student whose parent(s) did not complete a baccalaureate degree. Approximately a quarter of students identified as part of a historically underrepresented group, which includes members of the Black or African American, Hispanic racial and ethnic groups (See Table 2) (Office of Institutional Research and Decision Support, n.d.).

| Table 2: Demographic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs | |
|---|---|
| **Sex** | |
| Female | 9,719 (60.2%) |
| Male | 6,423 (39.8%) |
| **Age Bands** | |
| Under 18 | 89 (0.6%) |
| 18-24 | 10,551 (65.4%) |
| 25+ | 5,500 (34.1%) |
| **Race/Ethnicity** | |
| American Indian/Alaska Native | 13 (0.1%) |
| Asian | 3,185 (19.7%) |
| Black/African American | 2,227 (13.8%) |
| Hispanic/Latino | 1,550 (9.6%) |
| Native Hawaiian/Other Pacific Islander | 10 (0.1%) |
| Nonresident | 2,930 (18.2%) |
| Race/Ethnicity Unknown | 406 (2.5%) |
| Two or More Races | 616 (3.8%) |
| White | 5,205 (32.2%) |
| **First Generation** | |
| First-generation Undergraduates | 1,210 (7.5%) |
| Non-first-generation undergraduates | 6,616 (41.0%) |
| Unknown Undergraduates | 548 (3.4%) |
| Graduate Students | 7,768 (48.1%) |
| **Historically Underrepresented Groups (HUGS)** | |
| HUGS | 3,800 (23.5%) |
| Non-HUGS | 12,341 (76.5%) |

| Table 3: Demographic details of Emory's community by way of State House District 82 | |
|---|---|
| **Sex** | |
| Female | 26,006 (45.9%) |
| Male | 30,677 (54.1%) |
| **Age Bands** | |
| Under 18 | 9,983 (17.6%) |
| 18-64 | 38,167 (67.3%) |
| 65+ | 8,533 (15.1%) |
| **Race/Ethnicity** | |
| American Indian/Alaska Native | 74 (0.1%) |
| Asian | 5,554 (9.8%) |
| Black/African American | 8,237 (14.5%) |
| Hispanic/Latino | 4,468 (7.5%) |
| Native Hawaiian/Other Pacific Islander | 2 (0.0%) |
| Other | 49 (0.1%) |
| Two or More Races | 2,782 (4.9%) |
| White | 35,717 (63.0%) |
| **Economics** | |
| Persons below the poverty line | 548 (3.4%) |
| **Household income** | |
| Under $50K | 6,185 (26.2%) |
| $50K - $100K | 5,015 (21.2%) |
| $100K - $200K | 7,185 (30.4%) |
| Over $200K | 5,261 (22.3%) |

*Figure A2: Demographic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs.*
*Figure A3: Demographic details of Emory's community by way of State House District 82.*

Because non-student members of Emory's Recreation and Wellness facilities are the primary target population, this assessment must consider the community within a certain radius of the Atlanta campus. Therefore, this analysis uses data within the State House District 82 boundary since it includes Emory's Atlanta campus and the surrounding area where students, faculty, staff, and Emory's broader community may live (Census Reporter, n.d.).

According to the 2023 American Community Survey (ACS), State House District 82 has a total population of approximately 57,000 people. Unlike the student population at Emory, District 82 is majority male (54%). Adults ages 18-64 make up 67% of the population, and adults over 65 years old make up 15%. The White racial group is far more populous than others at 63% of the population. The Black or African American (15%), Asian (10%), Latino (8%), and Two or More Races (5%) categories follow. Like Emory's enrollment roster, District 82 has very small groups identifying in the Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander, and Native American or Alaskan Native racial and ethnic groups (U.S. Census Bureau, 2023).

According to the Pew Research Center's valuation of income, households in District 82 are mostly middle-income, reporting a median income of approximately $108,000 (Fry, (2024); U.S. Census Bureau, 2023). Around 3% of households within the district reported income below the Federal Poverty Line, and households earning less than $50,000 made up 26% of the population (See Table 3) (2023).

The population of students enrolled at Emory is similar to the broader community that surrounds it, but not the same. The university has a larger proportion of students—the majority being female—between the ages of 18 and 24. District 82's population is majority male, and adults have a wider age range. The district has a modest percentage of seniors, while

Emory presumably does not. Racial and ethnic groups across each locale are comparable in terms of the groups with the most people. White identifying individuals are the majority in both contexts; however, they are a substantial majority in District 82. Individuals identifying as Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander and Native American or Alaskan Native were extreme minorities in both community populations. The Black or African American, Asian, Latino, and Multi-racial groups also make up a smaller proportion of the total population; however, they are represented in higher numbers. District 82's median income falls within the middle-income category, and a small proportion of residents reported poverty and low income. The median household income at Emory is comparable at approximately $140,000, and similarly, the population includes students from households with low incomes (U.S. Census Bureau, 2023; Office of Institutional Research and Decision Support, n.d.; Aisch, 2017).

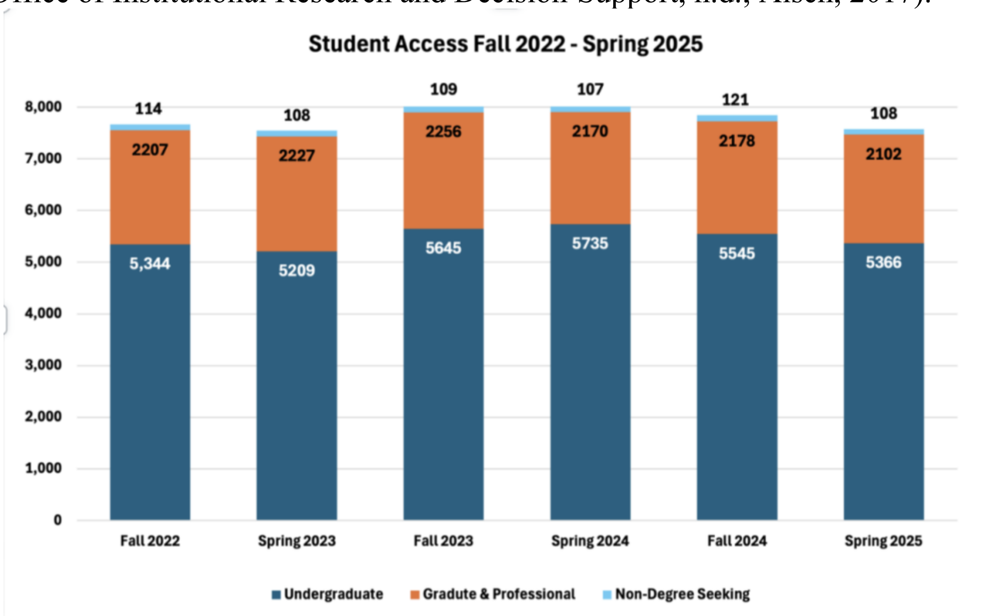



*Figure B1: Student Access to the Woodruff PE Center by Academic Level, Fall 2022–Spring 2025*

While both the Emory and District 82 provide insightful information and context, the RecWell community itself is a distinct population. The majority of RecWell users consist of students, with approximately 7,800 students accessing the Woodruff Physical Education Center (WPEC) each semester with a combined 170,000 visits per term (Emory Recreation & Wellness, internal data, 2025). 70% of the student users are undergraduates followed by 28% of graduate and professional students and lastly the non-degree seeking students makes up 2% (Emory Recreation & Wellness, internal data, 2025). Among student users, graduate students seemed to be more consistent in their usage compared to the fluctuating usage pattern of undergraduate students.

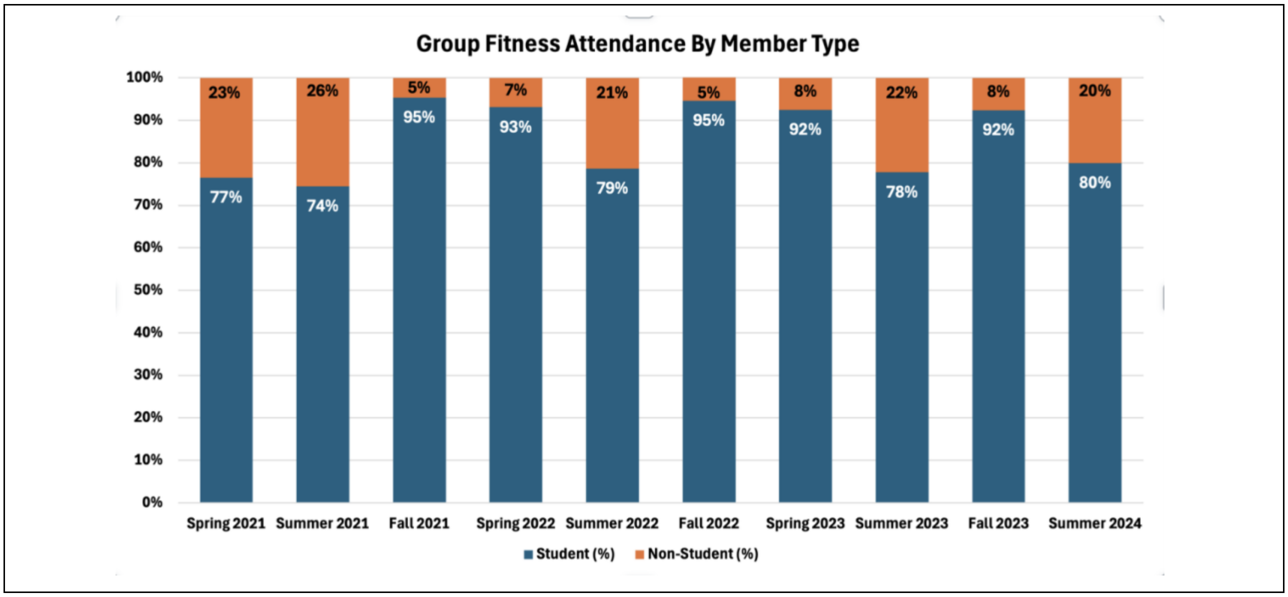



*Figure B2: Group fitness attendance by member type (student vs non-student).*

Non-student members make up a smaller portion of the RecWell user population. On average, the non-student account for 14% of group fitness class participation (Emory Recreation & Wellness, internal data, 2025). Data showed that attendance slightly increased during summer semesters when student presence declined.

These descriptive findings have certain implications for this assessment. Since non-student members are the primary population of interest, it helps to understand the makeup of the broader community surrounding the university. If non-student members mirror the makeup of the surrounding community, then differences between these two populations can indicate where this assessment should focus on its efforts to gather experiences and make recommendations. For example, a male in middle adulthood may not be representative of the student population; however, they might be better represented in the broader community and thus, the gym's non-student membership. Close attention to this nuance may steer this assessment towards meaningful findings and impactful recommendations.

### *Windshield Survey*

The purpose of this observation is to better understand the usage patterns and demographics of individuals who frequent Emory Recreation and Wellness. This may include factors such as occupancy of certain areas, such as the gym equipment, cardio machines, group fitness, or tennis and basketball court attendance. The observation took place on two separate occasions to capture variation in attendance and activity levels. The first session occurred on Wednesday, September 24th, at noon. The second observation was conducted on Friday, September 26th, after 5pm. These two timeframes were intentionally selected to provide a contrast between daytime and evening usage. It was anticipated that midday observation would reflect a different group of users. This could potentially be students with flexible schedules, as class breaks usually occur from 12 pm to 1 pm. This could also include faculty, staff, or paying members who also have flexibility in their schedules during this time. The evening observation could offer a broadened range of community members and students who may visit Emory Rec after work or after classes have concluded for the day.

In conducting this observation, I am observing as an insider, which limits the risk of the Hawthorne effect. While I won't be actively engaging with others or taking part in physical activity during the observation, my presence in the space will mirror that of any typical student or community member. I plan to position myself in a discreet and non-intrusive manner to ensure that my presence does not disturb the focus or routines of Emory Recreation and Wellness members. To record my observations, I will use the Notes app on my iPhone, which will allow me to document behaviors, patterns, and environmental details efficiently. Using my phone in this way will appear more natural and less conspicuous than carrying a notebook or laptop. This might draw unnecessary attention or create discomfort among those being observed. It also gives me the ability to walk freely with just my phone to jot down notes and blend in with the other students. I will refer to relevant notes from our community assessment to guide what I'm observing.  I do not anticipate a need to engage in any physical activity, as walking around the gym often goes unnoticed with all the activity. These observations will occur primarily on the fourth and first floors of Emory Rec, as these areas tend to have the most occupancy. In doing so, this will offer an unhindered view of members' activities without interfering.

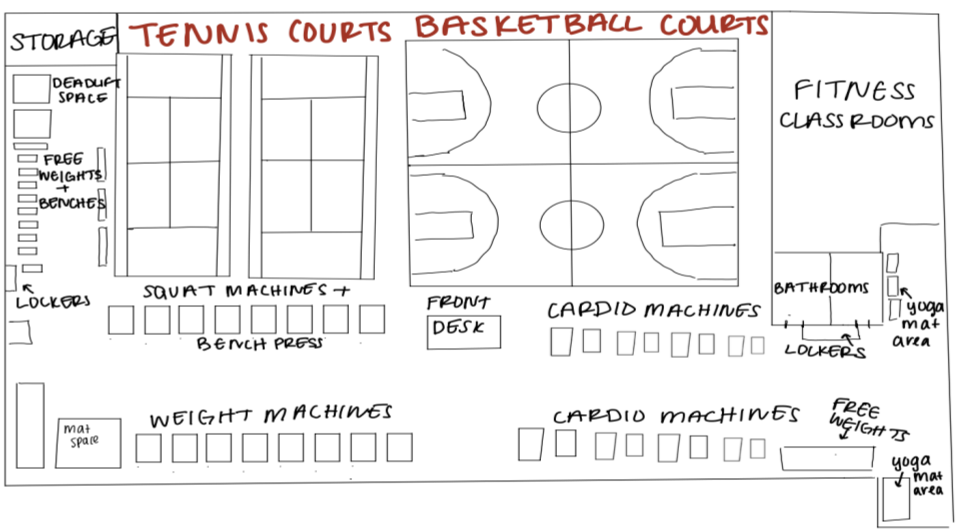
***Ethical Considerations***

I do not foresee any ethical concerns arising from my observational research of individuals using the facilities within Emory Recreation and Wellness. I will strictly adhere to ethical research practices by ensuring that no photographs or video recordings are taken, as I do not have the explicit consent of the individuals that I am observing. Additionally, as a student at Emory University, I have the same access rights to these spaces as any other member, which allows me to be present in these environments without disrupting their intended use. My presence and observations will be conducted in a manner that ensures minimal impact on the natural behaviors and routines of those in the space.

***Reflexive Note***

As a student who frequently uses Emory Recreation and Wellness facilities myself, I feel quite familiar with the space and cadence of activity that occurs during the week. Although my attendance has dwindled this past semester as I have found another gym to attend, I still feel quite myself in this area. This familiarity informs my observational approach while also requiring me to be mindful of my own biases and assumptions. I do acknowledge that my identity as a female graduate student who exercises regularly, I bring a unique positionality to this observation. My own identity and comfort level within gym spaces shape how I perceive and interpret the environment. Since I have previously used these spaces for my own workouts, I may unconsciously overlook behaviors or patterns that seem normal to me but could bear broader social and or cultural meaning. For this reason, I plan to approach the Emory Recreation and Wellness facility with a renewed sense of attention and hope to allow myself to see the facility as if it is the first time.

***Observation***




*Appendix C: Diagram of Woodruff PE Center 4th floor*

<u>Emory Recreation and Wellness, Wednesday, September 25th, 2025, 12:00 PM.</u>

The building felt calm as I walked through the entrance around noon with just my phone, wallet, and water bottle. I scanned through the gates and walked up to the fourth floor, where I assumed most of the activity would be. As I climbed the stairs, I looked into the neighboring rooms to see if there were any group classes in session. There were none at that time as I peered into each room through the glass windows. The first thing I noticed about the space was the cool

AC air and faint smell of disinfectant. As I walked up from the stairs into the gym space, the student at the front desk barely looked up from his laptop to greet me.

I looked to my right down the long hallway, where I heard some hustle and bustle. Groups of students passed through, some in clusters, some alone with earbuds in. I noticed a group of girls laughing as they made their way to the basketball court, likely athletes, judging by their Emory-branded jerseys and matching blue backpacks. They moved confidently through the space, clearly familiar with the routine.

As I headed toward the left side of the gym, I noticed the range of attire: athletic shorts, leggings, oversized t-shirts, and tank tops. Some students wore full matching workout sets, and others dressed more casually. It made me think about how appearance plays into today's gym culture and social media, and made me wonder who's here to sweat, who's here to be seen, and who might feel out of place?

The energy began to increase as students ended classes and filed into WPEC. They shoved backpacks into lockers and crowded the bathroom areas. The clang of metal echoed through the room as people re-racked weights or let them drop a little too hard. Most people appeared to be male-presenting, with a few women scattered throughout. The cardio machines lining the perimeter were mostly full. I spotted two women on treadmills walking side-by-side, chatting as they scrolled through their phones.

There was a clear rhythm to the space. People cycled through machines, took rests, checked their phones, and wiped down equipment. Most people kept to themselves. Most, if not everyone, had some sort of headphones in; occasionally, I observed students taking an earbud out to speak to one another.

I found a quiet spot near the stretching area on the right side of the gym to observe more closely. This space seemed less intense and a bit more open and relaxed. A few individuals were foam rolling or doing bodyweight exercises. Here, the gender distribution felt more balanced. It felt like a space people used to transition in or out of their workouts.

One thing I found myself paying attention to was how people moved through the space. There was a kind of unspoken etiquette, when to make eye contact, when to avoid it. People often glanced at a machine before approaching, maybe to gauge whether it's taken or if someone was mid-set. Some hovered near equipment, waiting without speaking. I'm reminded of how socially coded even neutral spaces like this can be, particularly when performance, strength, and appearance are silently on display.

As someone who has worked out in this facility before, none of this felt unfamiliar. And yet, observing through a different lens made me question what I might have previously overlooked. The gendered usage of space, silent boundaries, body language, comfort, and discomfort were all new details I was able to take in.

<u>Emory Recreation and Wellness, Friday, September 26th, 2025, 5:00 PM.</u>

The building was buzzing with energy when I arrived around 5 PM. It was noticeably busier than during my midday visit on Wednesday. Students poured in through the gates, where some still wore backpacks, and others were already dressed in workout clothes. The atmosphere felt electric, fast-paced, and extremely chaotic. There was a sense of urgency, but also familiarity, like many people had done this exact routine every Friday.

By the time I reached the fourth floor, the gym was completely packed. Every machine was in use, and people were waiting near the squat racks, benches, and free weights. Small groups clustered around the lifting areas, taking turns and encouraging each other between sets. There was a mix of seriousness and playfulness among the students. The cardio machines along the walls on the right side of the gym were full. There were rows of treadmills, ellipticals, and bikes all in use.

Faculty and older community members were also present, although fewer in number. They moved more quietly and deliberately, weaving through the crowds of students. Their presence added to the diversity of the space and highlighted how shared and overlapping this environment was, despite different fitness levels and routines.

Even the stretching and mat area, which was quiet earlier in the week, was now crowded. People stretched, foam rolled, or lay on mats, catching their breath between exercises. The energy here was more relaxed but still animated. The gender balance in this area felt more even than in the weight room, which remained mostly male-presenting.

Downstairs, on the first floor, the ping-pong tables were just as busy. Since the gym is split into two floors, the fourth floor and first floor, there were differing atmospheres between the two spaces. Although the gym was quite busy, the first floor offered a more relaxed and slower-paced environment. Students did not appear to be in such a rush, and there were more female presenting individuals on this level.

What struck me most was how communal the entire space felt. Unlike the segmented, efficient energy of the midday crowd, Friday evening brought everyone together. There were students, faculty, and what appeared to be local members moving through the gym at once. There was a kind of shared rhythm, even among strangers. The gym didn't just feel like a place to work out; it felt like an extension of campus life. The energy was intense, but familiar, marked by movement, routine, and an unspoken understanding of how to navigate the space together.

## Community Resources and Assets

The Emory Recreation and Wellness Center is a unique resource-rich organization that is in an environment that offers a wide range of community assets. These assets contribute to the physical, mental, and social well-being of Emory students, faculty, staff, and surrounding community members. Our assessment has shown several core resources that are both internal and external to Emory. These then can be leveraged to enhance participation, engagement, and overall wellness outcomes.

### *Institutional Resources at Emory University*

As a leading research university, Emory offers significant institutional strengths that support the mission of the Recreation and Wellness Center. These are seen as Interdepartmental Collaboration Opportunities. Emory's academic departments, such as Public Health, Nursing, Medicine, and even student service units, such as counseling and psychological services, and the office of health promotion, represent important institutional partners. Their existing programming, staff expertise, and outreach infrastructure can be leveraged to support holistic health promotion initiatives. Student organizations and peer leaders play a vital role. Emory has a diverse set of student organizations, including wellness ambassadors and health-focused clubs, that aid in disseminating information and organizing health-related events. Another aspect is health promotion and preventive services. This office offers resources such as sexual health education, stress reduction workshops, and wellness coaching. These existing services align closely with the goals of the Recreation and Wellness Center and may serve as avenues for co-programming. There is also the digital communication infrastructure. Where they give the prevalence of digital communication among students, Emory's existing email systems, campus-wide newsletters, and student engagement platforms offer powerful tools for increasing awareness and participation in recreation services

### *Physical Infrastructure and Facility Strengths*

The Recreation and Wellness Center itself is a major asset. The facility features:

- State-of-the-Art Fitness Equipment: Including a full suite of cardio machines, weightlifting stations, and functional fitness spaces.
- Dedicated Spaces for Group Fitness and Recreation: These include basketball and racquetball courts, stretching areas, and group fitness studios.
- Multipurpose and Inclusive Spaces: Observations during peak and midday times indicate that specific areas (such as stretching zones and ping-pong tables on the first floor) offer inclusive, low-pressure environments that appeal to a more diverse range of users, including faculty, members, and older adults
- Flexible Usage Patterns: The variation in attendance across timeframes suggests that the facility already supports a wide range of community members, including undergraduate and graduate students, faculty, staff, and paying community members, allowing for tailored engagement strategies depending on user demographics.

### *Social Capital and Campus Culture*

Another unique thing is how the Emory Recreation and Wellness Center provides an intangible but powerful sense of connection. This is seen through community and overall belonging. Observational data from our visits indicate that the facility functions not just as a gym, but as a community hub. We see social groups, informal interactions, and shared activities. These all demonstrate the potential of this space to promote interpersonal connection, mental wellness, and social cohesion across diverse campus groups. Next, the user flow and unspoken gym etiquette observed (examples: shared usage of equipment, transition zones, social clustering) provide insights into how community norms support respectful, coordinated use of the space. These dynamics are an asset that can be reinforced in orientation materials or peer-led wellness programs. Finally, the gym’s layout unintentionally segments participation by activities, yet the facility’s flexibility in design (examples: quieter stretching zones, relaxed first-floor spaces) can be leveraged to improve inclusive engagement with targeted programming for all groups.

### *Broader Community and Geographic Assets*

Situated in the Druid Hills neighborhood within Georgia State House District 82, the Emory campus is embedded in a larger, mostly middle-income, health-literate population. Key regional assets include:

- Affluent, Health-Conscious Population: District 82 is characterized by high educational attainment and a median income of $108,000. This shows a strong potential for external community partnerships and support for wellness initiatives.
- Diverse Population Base: While the majority is White, the area includes a significant proportion of African American(15%), Asian (10%), and Latino (8%) residents. This diversity allows the Rec Center to build programs that reflect the cultural and social health needs of multiple demographic groups.
- Access to MARTA Bus Transit: While limited compared to rail access, existing public transit routes do connect the Emory campus with broader Atlanta neighborhoods, allowing for outreach to residents and off-campus students who may rely on public transportation.

*Digital and Technological Resource*

The literature also highlights the growing potential of wearable technology, mobile apps, and digital communication tools to increase both facility usage and awareness. This is seen as follows:

- Social Media Integration: Given that a significant portion of students receive campus information through social media (particularly Instagram and email), the Recreation and Wellness Center is well-positioned to boost participation through targeted digital outreach media.
- Data-Driven Decision Making: Opportunities exist to explore low-cost, privacy-protective wearable or other data collection systems to better understand facility usage patterns. This can allow Rec & Wellness to allocate resources more equitably and adapt to evolving usage needs.


*Appendix D: Diagram of Community Resources and Assets*

# Methods

## Team Positionality Statement

The Community Assessment team consists of six graduate students from the Rollins School of Public Health. As current students affiliated with the institution we are evaluating, we recognize that our positions may shape how we understand Emory Recreation and Wellness, how key informants perceive us, and how we interpret the data they provide. Our roles as student researchers inherently differ from those of the key informants, many of whom are professional and student staff with deep, operational knowledge of the Recreation and Wellness Center. This status difference may influence the types of information interviewees feel comfortable sharing, as well as the assumptions we bring to the assessment.

We also acknowledge that our personal experiences using- or not using- the Recreation and Wellness facilities may bias our expectations about student and community member utilization. To mitigate these potential influences, we approached each interview with intentional reflexivity and used a standardized interview guide. Our goal was to interpret findings through an objective, equity-centered lens while remaining aware that our identities as students and emerging public health practitioners shape how we understand the campus community and its needs.

## Key Informants Protocol

### *Sampling and Recruitment*

Key Informants were chosen for their in-depth knowledge of Emory Recreation and Wellness, informed by their experiences as current or former employees or student-athletes. April Flint, the Senior Director of Recreation and Wellness, and Alyssa O'Keefe, the Associate Director of Recreation and Wellness, provided the Community Assessment team with a list of five potential key informants. After reviewing those mentioned, the team contacted three individuals from the list due to their extensive knowledge of Emory Recreational facilities and experiences with the facility, with two individuals as potential back-up interviewees if needed.

The final list of key informants was as follows: Jasmine Gresham, Coordinator of Fitness and Wellness; Olivier Jawornicki, student staff, varsity and club student-athlete, and recreation participant; and Samantha O'Brien, Assistant Director of Recreation and Athletic Facilities and Operations. April Flint and Alyssa O'Keefe served as backup interviewees, if needed. This sample size is sufficient because it provides a scoping overview of operations from a multitude of perspectives. As the key informant interviews primarily serve as a stepping-stone for the creation of the survey, the variation in participant roles allows the Community Assessment team to have a more comprehensive insight into Emory Recreation and Wellness.

Once identified by April Flint and Alyssa O'Keefe, the Key Informants were selected and contacted by the Community Assessment team via email. If the interviewees did not respond within 2 business days, the backup Key Informants were to be contacted using the same email. As all the primary Key Informants responded within the allocated time, the backup interviewees were not contacted. Before contacting Key Informants about interviewing, the team drafted the following email script:

> Good afternoon, ___________. My name is _________ and I am working with a team of fellow graduate students at the Emory University Rollins School of Public Health to assess Emory Recreation and Wellness. We are working alongside April Flint and Alyssa O'Keefe from Emory Rec to help better serve the Emory community through improved metrics and usage of recreational resources.
>
> April and Alyssa named you as a person who has a well-rounded understanding of Emory Rec and could help provide unique insight into their workings, resources, and needs. They provided us with your information so we could reach out to a potential interview. Would you have any availability this week for a phone or Zoom call? The interview would take no longer than 30 minutes and is entirely confidential. Please let us know some available time slots if you are open to participating.
>
> We appreciate your time and look forward to hearing from you.
>
> Best,

The Community Assessment Team

### *Primary Collection*

Data will be collected using semi-structured interviews. Questions were created with the intent of capturing the interviewee's perception and insight about Emory's recreational facilities and utilization of resources.

These questions were designed through the collaborative effort of the Community Assessment team and were guided by two prior meetings with April Flint and Alyssa O'Keefe. To ensure consistency and reliability, all key informant interviews will be conducted by members of our Community Assessment team using a standard interview guide. Interviews will be held via Zoom or phone call, depending on the preference and availability of each participant. This format allows for flexibility in scheduling and increased accessibility for both student and professional informants. While in-person interviews were considered, this virtual format is best suited for accommodating varying schedules and ensuring the timely completion of all interviews.

Each interview will last approximately 30 minutes and will follow a semi-structured format using a shared interview guide developed collaboratively with input from the Emory Recreation and Wellness director and associate director. Through carefully crafted questions, the interview guide targets topics related to the Emory community's awareness and perception of recreation resources, patterns of utilization pertaining to gym activities and available equipment, barriers to access, perceived strengths and weaknesses in current processes, and recommendations for future improvements.

With verbal consent, interviews will be **a**udio-recorded using the built-in Zoom recording function. In addition to recording, the interviewer will also take brief notes to capture contextual or non-verbal insights (such as tone, pauses, emphasis). Transcription software or note recording apps, such as the Zoom built-in transcription feature, may be utilized to aid in transcription.

The first interview was with Olivier Jawornicki and was conducted by Madison Benjamin. The second interview with Samantha O'Brien was conducted by Victoria Ostebo. The final interview with Jasmine Gresham was conducted by Sofia Charlot. For each interview, the named team members served as the primary interviewers, and interview audio recordings, transcripts, and notes were uploaded into the team's Microsoft OneDrive, which is accessible to the six members of our Community Assessment team.

### *Data Management and Analysis*

All audio files will be stored in a secure, team-only Microsoft OneDrive folder, accessible only to the six members of our Community Assessment Team. These recordings will be used solely for this assignment and will be deleted upon project completion to protect privacy and uphold ethical standards. Each audio file will be labeled with a participant code rather than real names to maintain confidentiality.

Interviews will be transcribed using Zoom's automated transcription tool, followed by manual review and light editing to correct inaccuracies. Transcriptions will be de-identified to remove names, roles, or other identifying information unless explicit permission has been granted by the participant to retain such details. All notes and transcripts will be stored in the same OneDrive folder and treated with the same confidentiality safeguards.

This approach ensures responsible data handling in line with ethical research principles, allows for efficient synthesis during the analysis phase, and respects the time, insight, and privacy of our key informants.

The preliminary data analysis will consist of a thematic exploration of our three key interviews. There will not be employment in coding for this stage. After each interview, team members will upload an audio file, Zoom transcript, and interview notes made available to all team members through a Microsoft OneDrive folder. Each team member will read either interview notes or transcripts to identify recurring thematic markings. Following individual analyses, our group will share and synthesize findings from each interview to establish broader, overarching themes. These themes will shape subsequent data collection methods, refine topics that are covered, and guide the overall research strategy for the rest of the Program Evaluation.

## Primary Data Collection

### *Data Collection Instrument*

Primary data collection utilized the Qualtrics Digital Survey platform to ensure ease of dispersion and awareness for the student and member populations. The Qualtrics software allows for a monitored environment of responses while ensuring data is safely collected. The survey was published for three weeks and collected responses from October 21, 2025, to November 11, 2025. See Appendix C for the primary data collection instrument.

Primary data collection was conducted through a virtual survey distributed across Emory Recreation's communication channels. This method aligns with the goal of efficiently collecting data from a large and diverse sample of facility users. Surveys capture both qualitative and quantitative data regarding behaviors, needs, and user experiences. They are quick, cost-effective, and easily available to individuals with busy and changing schedules. Conversely, surveys are dependent on response rates and do not allow for probing or clarification of responses. Self-reported data is susceptible to biases, such as social desirability or recall, and misinterpretation by the participants. Despite these limitations, surveys are still the most appropriate and practical data collection method for this community assessment.

The Emory Recreation and Wellness Center serves a large and diverse population of students, staff, faculty, and community members, so a survey is best suited to engage this audience. Emory Recreation is part of a university and a public health institution. Its members likely have limited time and compete with professional or academic priorities. Since this data collection method is accessible via mobile devices, it is quick, convenient, and increases the chances of collecting a large and complete sample. Additionally, the community assessment evaluated quantitative usage data alongside qualitative findings for context. The survey offered an ideal vehicle for this approach. Multiple-choice and Likert scale questions captured quantitative usage and experiential outcomes, while open-ended questions captured detailed, nuanced, and individualized perspectives. Overall, this survey provided a comprehensive overview of the average user's experiences, needs, barriers, and awareness.

Survey questions were developed by the community assessment team. Meetings with RecWell staff and three key informant interviews also informed the survey. These conversations identified topics to explore and help shape the language and structure of the survey. Survey domains included facility use, activity preference, limitations and motivations of facility use, awareness of resources, and overall satisfaction.

Overall, the purpose of this survey was to gather data from student and non-student members about their usage of Emory Recreation and Wellness facilities. This tool supported that goal by capturing a large sample of high-level observations. These observations help piece together the average user's experience.

### *Sampling and Recruitment*

This community assessment utilized a convenience sampling approach to recruit participants. Because convenience sampling involves selecting individuals who are easily accessible and willing to participate, this strategy was appropriate for the current assessment. Although this method introduces sampling bias, it is effective for exploratory research and offers a practical means of reaching relevant participants within the target population of student and non-student members of Emory Recreation.

To ensure that the sample reflected the experiences and perspectives of individuals actively engaged in the organization, the study included both student members and non-student members. These individuals made up the inclusion criteria for primary data collection. There were no exclusion criteria for this survey. Most respondents responded via an anonymous link that was promoted on campus, but accessible to both students and non-students. Question three in the survey asks respondents to indicate which of the two Emory Recreation facilities they use, with the option to indicate neither. Respondents who indicated that they used neither facility were not excluded from the survey because they could potentially offer insight into barriers to utilization or issues with awareness.

This data collection effort aimed to have at least 50 participants. The goal was to recruit as many participants as possible to gather a broad and diverse range of responses, reduce the impact of sampling bias, and provide a comprehensive understanding of the issues being explored. To encourage a large sample, Emory Recreation offered two incentive options for survey completion: one free Intramural Play Pass for the Spring 2026 semester or one free InBody Body Composition assessment to be used before May 2026. At the end of the survey, respondents were asked to include an email address to be entered in a raffle where the five winners would choose between the two incentive options.

Emory Recreation distributed a recruitment email with the survey linked to the existing email lists of student and non-student members. This recruitment approach leveraged the formal networks within the organization to ensure efficient and targeted outreach. By distributing the survey through these channels, the study maximizes the potential for participation while maintaining alignment with ethical recruitment practices. Emory Recreation also displayed virtual flyers on TV screens within the Woodruff P.E. Center and the Student Activity and Academic Center (SAAC) with a QR code directing interested parties to the survey. The community assessment planning team did in-person recruitment inside of the WPEC by passing out flyers and giving away small Emory Recreation promotional gifts. Participants also responded to promotional messages printed on flyers posted around campus. With this targeted recruitment, the survey reached a wide cross-section of Emory Recreation members. At the end of survey data collection, there were 341 unique survey responses.

### *Data Management and Analysis*

A community assessment team member actively monitored survey response rates for the three-week duration of data collection. Following this period, survey data was exported from Qualtrics and transferred to Microsoft Excel for cleaning, and then to Statistical Analysis System (SAS), and Python for statistical analysis. The raw data was stored in a private OneDrive folder. Access to all data was limited to the community assessment team, the community assessment partners at Emory Recreation, and the course professor.

Data cleaning efforts involve compiling and reviewing responses for completeness. Forty-four survey responses that were less than 15% complete were coded as missing and excluded from analysis. Most survey questions included an “other” option where respondents could write in options that were not included as answer choices. Those responses were included as additional options. If there was an overlap between the text entry responses and the answer choices, the text entry response was recoded as the matching answer choice.

Once cleaned, a descriptive analysis of the survey data produced counts and percentages for each multiple-choice question. Summary statistics for Likert scale questions included the mean, median, and standard deviation as well. These numeric summaries provided a high-level overview of facility usage, awareness of facility offerings, barriers to usage, and group fitness participation. All descriptive analyses were conducted using SAS 9.4.

Next, statistical analysis helped ascertain differences in facility usage patterns, barriers to access, and satisfaction levels between two distinct member groups at Emory Recreation. Participants were categorized based on their membership status as indicated by their response to question one in the survey. Group 1 consisted of student members (n=146). Group 2 comprised non-student members (n=152), for a total sample size of 298 respondents.

Survey question four asked what types of activities do respondents usually participate in. Survey question six asked respondents what barriers, if any, prevented them from accessing or participating in Emory Recreation facilities and programs. For these two questions, responses were parsed into binary indicators for each option (selected=1, not selected=0). Chi-square tests of independence were conducted to assess whether the proportion of respondents selecting each option differed significantly between the two membership groups.

Survey question seven asked respondents to rank their satisfaction with the current RecWell offerings. An independent samples t-test was performed to compare mean satisfaction scores between groups, with the assumption of unequal variances. The Mann-Whitney U test was conducted as a non-parametric alternative to confirm findings. Effect size was calculated using Cohen's d. Statistical significance was set at $\alpha = 0.05$, with Bonferroni correction considered for multiple comparisons where appropriate. All analyses were conducted using Python 3.x with pandas, SciPy, and stats model libraries.

Survey question eight asked an open-ended question about what improvements or additional offerings would make respondents more likely to participate in RecWell programs or activities. Survey question ten offered respondents a chance to share any additional information about their engagement with Emory Recreation. Reflexive thematic analysis was conducted for this textual data to identify any patterns of meaning. Written responses for each question were reviewed and coded manually. Relevant code segments were then grouped together to generate initial themes. After further evaluation and interpretation of codes and code groups, seven themes were constructed from the responses to question eight, and four themes were constructed from the responses to question ten.

### Data Triangulation Methods

Data triangulation was utilized to maximize validity and ensure consistency across the various data sources informing this assessment. See Table 1 in Appendix D for more detail. The triangulation table included columns for each data collection method. Methods utilized for this assessment were a literature review, secondary data analysis, a windshield survey, asset mapping, key-informant interviews, and primary data collection and analysis. Each row included a key finding about the community's needs. The cells in each row included a summary of the evidence that corresponds to each need. The various data sources produced six key needs: 1) facility access and availability issues in terms of hours and crowding, 2) low awareness of recreational resources and group fitness opportunities, 3) lack of equipment in rotation, 4) financial barriers to usage of recreational facilities and resources, 5) feeling unwelcome or intimidated in recreational facility spaces, and 6) activity preferences differ substantially between student and non-student members.

## Results and Findings

### Key-Informant Interview Findings

#### *Sample Characteristics*

Three key informants were interviewed based on their extensive knowledge of Emory Recreation and Wellness operations and user experiences. Informants were selected from a pool of five potential candidates identified by April Flint (Senior Director of Recreation and Wellness) and Alyssa O'Keefe (Associate Director of Recreation and Wellness). The final sample consisted of Jasmine Gresham (Coordinator of Fitness and Wellness), Olivier Jawornicki (student staff member, varsity and club student-athlete, and recreation participant), and Samantha O'Brien (Assistant Director of Recreation and Athletic Facilities and Operations). This composition ensured representation across multiple operational levels, including administrative leadership, facilities management, and direct user experience, thereby providing comprehensive insight into both organizational functions and member engagement patterns across diverse populations.

#### *Findings*

An examination of key interviews showed five main ideas that would later guide the creation of survey tools. The most reported problem was access to facilities when crowds peaked. Jasmine said busy times made the atmosphere feel overwhelming, so she wouldn't suggest it to newcomers. Instead of equal use across areas, Sam pointed out some items, like basketballs or short-term lockers, got constant demand, whereas others, such as the racquetball courts, rarely saw activity. Rather than spreading evenly, people tended to arrive right after classes ended. This clustering between late afternoon and early evening led to overcrowding. As a result, those with tight timetables faced greater difficulty getting in.

Second, researchers found major blind spots in how much users understand about what's on offer. Jasmine pointed out that many visitors don't realize the main building has four levels. Sam added that although some classes fill up fast, some sports get little action because people rarely hear about opportunities to engage. Interviewees highlighted contrasts between user groups: students tend to join scheduled events more often, while non-student members usually work out solo or follow personal routines. This split implies varied information habits and differing expectations, meaning one-size-fits-all messaging might miss its mark.

Third, access to gear showed broad sufficiency yet revealed narrow gaps. Sam described supply levels as "fairly sufficient," though certain weaknesses stood out, and he noted layouts may benefit minor tweaks to better serve learners. Jasmine supported this view and added that non-student community users often grumble about crowded machines when school hours peak, pointing to the strain between groups sharing infrastructure. Fourth, money-related aspects shaped how pleased people felt; both interviewees observed complaints rising among non-enrolled customers focused on upkeep quality or broken tools, linking sharper critique directly to payment status driving higher standards due to personal cost. Fifth, fear triggers, along with structural choices, appeared capable of limiting involvement. Jasmine pointed out that the upper-level workout zone's layout feels uneasy since its walkways resemble bridges overhead, making exercisers feel constant observation without privacy zones. Such findings of hint discomfort could impact particular user types more strongly, calling for deeper number-based analysis later.

### Primary Data Collection Findings

***Sample Characteristics***

Data collection was conducted through an online survey distributed via multiple channels, including email announcements, social media platforms, facility signage, and in-person recruitment through tabling activities at the Woodruff P.E. Center (WPEC). The final sample comprised 300 respondents representing diverse membership categories: Emory students (48.7%, n=146), university employees (26.0%, n=78), healthcare employees (6.0%, n=18), retirees (4.0%, n=12), affiliates (3.7%, n=11), community members (5.7%, n=17), and other membership categories (5.3%, n=16). For comparative analysis addressing research questions concerning differences between member types, respondents were categorized into two analytical groups: Student members (n=146, 48.7%) and Non-student members (n=152, 50.7%). The sample predominantly consisted of active facility users with a mean visitation frequency of 2.57 visits per week (SD=0.86), indicating typical engagement of two to three times weekly. The Woodruff P.E. Center served as the primary recreation site for 64.3% of respondents, while 15.0% primarily used the Student Activity and Academic Center, 15.7% regularly utilized both facilities, and 2.7% used neither despite maintaining active membership status.

***Findings***

Descriptive findings showed weight training was the top choice at 59.7%, then cardio at 38.3%, group workouts at 25.0%, and water-based programs at 19.3%; this suggests solo exercise types are more common across centers. Health improvement drove participation for 89.3% of users; next came emotional well-being (61.3%), managing pressure (60.7%), or simply liking it (53.0%) - so even if places support interaction, their main appeal links to personal physical and psychological gains. Time limitations were cited by nearly half (46.7%) as a hurdle; lack of drive affected 24.7%, while unknown issues impacted 19.0%. On average, approval stood mid-range (mean = 3.36, standard deviation = 1.40) on a five-level rating, with less than half expressing mild contentment, yet close to 20% felt somewhat unhappy. Most relied on email updates (42.7%) for news, but significantly, almost 1 in 7 said they rarely learn what's offered, pointing to weak outreach performance.

***Comparative Analysis: Student Members vs. Non-Student Members***

To address research questions examining differences between member types, chi-square tests of independence were conducted for categorical variables while independent samples t-tests were performed for continuous variables, with statistical significance established at $\alpha=0.05$. Survey responses were parsed into binary indicators for categorical variables, and Mann-Whitney U tests confirmed findings for continuous measures. Effect sizes were calculated using Cohen's d, with all analyses conducted using Python 3.x.

The comparison showed six main results. Firstly, time limits hit harder among student members - nearly two times more likely than non-student members saw this as an issue (62.3% versus 32.2%, $\chi^2=25.88$, $p<0.001$); it was the biggest gap found, matching feedback asking for longer access after work hours, on weekends, or during school holidays. Secondly, gaps in awareness were similar across both groups (4.1% compared to 5.9%, $p=0.65$), meaning unclear information impacts them equally, which hints that outreach methods aren't working well for either group. Thirdly, price concerns came up much more often from student members - even though they pay less, they mentioned cost 3.7× more than non-student members (17.8% vs. 4.8%, $\chi^2=11.14$, $p<0.001$) - possibly due to worries about future expenses, extra fees, or what they might lose by spending time here instead of elsewhere.

Fourth, fear came up mostly for student members - twelve times more often than for non-student members (15.8% vs. 1.3%, $\chi^2$=18.36, p<0.001) - which hints that gyms may feel intimidating, especially to younger or newer visitors. On the flip side, feeling excluded didn't differ much between groups (4.8% vs. 5.3%, p=1.00), so discomfort seems tied more to self-assurance and skill than outright rejection. Fifth, what people liked doing varied sharply by group: team sports were far more common among student members, whereas non-student members chose water-based workouts nearly five times as often. Student members also did cardio somewhat more frequently (45.2% vs. 32.2%, $\chi^2$=4.75, p=0.029); however, lifting weights looked about the same across both types (64.4% vs. 55.9%, p=0.17). These patterns imply student members lean into fast, casual, group-driven options fitting around school demands; meanwhile, non-student members prefer fixed routines needing planning and consistency.

Sixth, although student members faced greater obstacles - such as limited time, feeling intimidated, or worrying about expenses - they expressed more satisfaction than non-student members (M=3.79, SD=0.99 vs. M=3.46, SD=1.15, t(277)=2.57, p=0.011, Cohen's d=0.31), confirmed by Mann-Whitney U test (U=11229, p=0.015). Contrary to what one might expect, this result can be explained in different ways: their experience could match or go beyond what they hoped for once they gained entry; alternatively, because the services are free or low-cost, student members may start with lower assumptions, unlike non-student members who weigh benefits against price; another possibility is that being around peers adds extra enjoyment for student members, a factor less present among non-student members. Therefore, reducing hurdles for student member participation might boost overall outcomes more effectively than expanding activities, whereas improving perceived worth, service standards, or variety could matter more for non-student members.

## Limitations

While our project provides valuable insights and actionable recommendations for Emory RecWell, there are several limitations to consider when interpreting the findings and their implications.

1. Sampling Bias.

Our survey was distributed primarily through Emory social media/email sources and RecWell-affiliated platforms, which may have led to a self-selection bias. Participants who are more actively engaged with RecWell or who had strong opinions (positive or negative) were more likely to respond. As a result, the feedback may overrepresent highly engaged users and underrepresent more casual or disengaged members. Ideally, we would want to reach those who do not currently attend the gym and how we can get them to come.

2. Limited Generalization

While we received over 300 survey responses and conducted multiple key informant interviews, our findings may not be fully generalizable to the entire Emory RecWell population, especially individuals who do not regularly engage with RecWell services and thus did not respond to the survey. Additionally, most data were collected during the Fall 2025 semester, which may not capture needs or usage patterns during different academic terms or seasons.

3. Key Informant Constraints

Our key informant interviews were limited to a couple of individuals, most of whom were professional staff members. We were unable to secure interviews with student workers or maintenance staff due to scheduling and availability, which may have constrained our understanding of on-the-ground operational issues and staff perspectives.

4. Limited Demographic Breakdown

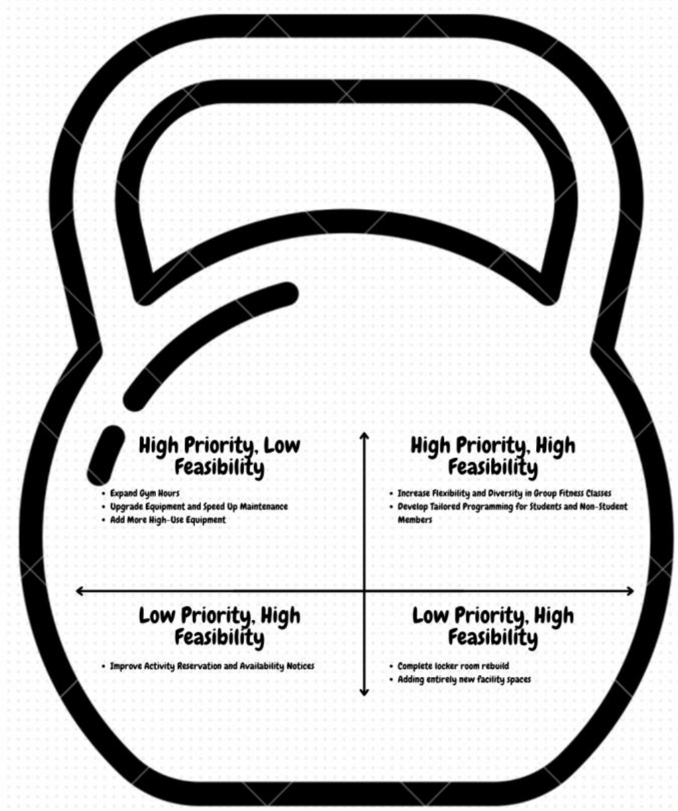
Although we asked for demographic data, we did not conduct in-depth subgroup analysis (such as by race, gender, or disability status) due to time constraints and limited representation in some categories. As a result, our ability to speak to equity-related issues for specific marginalized populations is limited, even though we recognize that these are important considerations for inclusive programming.

5. Feasibility Scoring Subjectivity

Our prioritization process included feasibility and importance matrices, which involved some subjective judgment from our team. While we grounded these in qualitative and quantitative data, feasibility in particular was assessed without direct operational or budgetary data from RecWell. Thus, our feasibility rankings should be interpreted as preliminary guidance rather than definitive assessments.

6. Time Constraints

This project was completed within a single academic semester, which limited our ability to conduct follow-up interviews, longitudinal tracking, or pilot-testing of interventions. Severalof our recommendations would benefit from further study, phased implementation, and ongoing feedback loops.




*Appendix E: Priorities Matrix*

## Recommendations

Our final recommendations are the result of a rigorous process of data triangulation, drawing from both the quantitative survey and qualitative key informant interviews conducted with Emory RecWell stakeholders. By comparing open-ended responses, numerical trends, and stakeholder perspectives, we were able to identify high-priority, high-feasibility action items that meet the real needs of the Emory RecWell community.

To organize our recommendations, we used a Needs Matrix (assessing user demand and thematic frequency) and a Priorities Matrix (evaluating both importance and feasibility based on stakeholder input and infrastructure realities). These tools helped us sort dozens of suggestions into actionable tiers and guided our final list of six top recommendations. These six recommendations are rooted in evidence, tailored to stakeholder context, and aligned with RecWell's strategic goals of inclusivity, access, and engagement.

1. Expand Gym Hours

One of the most frequently voiced concerns was the limited gym hours. This theme emerged across all user types, particularly graduate students, staff, and Emory Healthcare employees, who often work nontraditional or inflexible hours. Currently, RecWell opens at 7 am and closes at 11 pm on weekdays, with shorter hours on weekends. Many expressed a desire for earlier openings or later closings, especially to accommodate early risers or those with evening obligations.

While extended hours require staffing and budget considerations, even modest changes, like opening 30 minutes earlier or extending weekend hours, could significantly increase satisfaction and equity. This is rated medium in importance and medium in feasibility but has the potential for high return on investment.

2. Improve Cleanliness and Locker Room Updates

Cleanliness concerns surfaced in 28 open-ended survey responses, primarily focused on showers, locker rooms, and floor hygiene. Some described locker rooms as "musty" or "dated," and multiple respondents noted the lack of consistent cleaning schedules or visible maintenance accountability.

This issue, while less emotionally charged than group fitness or equipment access, is highly feasible to address. Improving signage for cleaning schedules, placing feedback kiosks, and implementing quarterly locker room upgrades (such as replacing curtains, fixing broken fixtures, updating tiles, and new lockers) would signal responsiveness and increase comfort, especially for women, older adults, and people with disabilities, who may be more sensitive to cleanliness and accessibility. Given its low cost and high feasibility, this is considered a quick-win opportunity to boost RecWell's reputation and user retention.

3. Upgrade Equipment and Maintenance Speed

A total of 33 participants commented on broken, outdated, or insufficient equipment. This was particularly frustrating for users who engage in strength training, cardio routines, or machine-based rehab. Participants cited examples like treadmills being offline for weeks or waiting forever to use squat racks, benches, or certain machines.

To address this, RecWell should consider:

- A public-facing repair tracker, showing expected timelines for broken machines.
- Prioritizing high-traffic equipment for replacement during budget cycles.
- Scheduling monthly proactive inspections of machines in high-use areas.
- Adding more units of high-demand equipment (such as squat racks, benches, ellipticals, cable machines, and other specific high-use machines) to reduce wait times and overcrowding during peak hours.
- Reconfiguring floor space, if necessary, to accommodate additional machines without sacrificing safety or accessibility. (One of the most challenging factors)

This recommendation ranks medium in importance and medium in feasibility. It's less urgent than group fitness but still contributes significantly to long-term satisfaction.

4. Increase Flexibility and Diversity in Group Classes

This emerged as the #1 priority based on both frequency (mentioned by over 100 respondents) and alignment with RecWell's mission to support diverse participation. Users want:

- More flexible class times, including early mornings and evenings.
- Less schedule overlap between popular offerings (Pilates, Cycling)
- Broader variety: yoga, Zumba, HIIT, dance, martial arts, Tai Chi, etc.
- Cultural inclusivity, with classes that reflect global traditions and serve a broader demographic.

Interviewees emphasized that class schedule conflicts are a dealbreaker for working adults, and that current offerings tend to prioritize undergraduate students. In addition, my popular classes are booked at the same time and only offered to a limited number of students. With these classes filling up so quick, many people don't get the opportunity to engage in the fitness activity. The addition of a couple more classes (especially popular ones) would allow for more engagement and user satisfaction.

Because this recommendation is both highly important and highly feasible, it ranks as the top strategic opportunity. We suggest that RecWell pilot a rotating group fitness model, adding pop-up classes, cultural fusion classes, and user-selected instructors. This will allow them to see how high an interest level the classes and have the times for them, and then they can officially lock in the new classes and times.

5. Improve Activity Reservations & Real-Time Activity

We heard consistent concerns about the reservation system, especially for racquetball courts, swim lanes, and basketball courts. Several users reported showing up to find reserved spaces closed or double-booked, and many were unaware of how to use the current booking system.

Recommendations include:

- Real-time dashboards showing court/pool availability via screens or an app.
- Push notifications for last-minute closures or changes.
- Clear signage about reservation rules and timing.

This is moderately important but highly feasible, as RecWell already uses technology platforms that could support these upgrades. This recommendation supports transparency and reduces user frustration, particularly for high-intensity users like competitive swimmers or intramural teams.

6. Develop Tailored Programming for Students & Non-Students

Our sixth recommendation stems from Finding 6, which identified distinct differences in usage patterns and preferences between students and non-student members (faculty, staff, and community users). Students tend to prefer social, flexible, high-energy options like group fitness and team sports, whereas non-students often value structured, solo workouts such as early-morning routines, lap swimming, and small group training.

We recommend:

- By designing targeted programming tracks that reflect these differences, RecWell can better meet the needs of both groups. This could include:

- More evening and social fitness options for students, such as pop-up classes or intramural expansions.

- More early-morning, small-group, or lunchtime classes for non-students, designed around traditional work schedules and specific goals.

- Designing culturally responsive programs that reflect member identities (Such as Tai Chi Night, Latin dance, LGBTQ+ yoga, mindfulness workshops).

- Labeling classes more clearly in the app so users can easily identify intensity level, style, and suitability.

This allows for "Student Life Fitness" and "Community Wellness" tracks. This recommendation is rated high in importance and medium-high in feasibility. It would enhance user engagement, reduce scheduling conflicts, and reflect a more equity-focused design philosophy.

## Conclusion

In collaboration with Emory Recreation and Wellness Center, graduate students from Rollins School of Public Health at Emory University conducted this community assessment (CA) to explore how Emory's diverse campus community, including students, faculty, staff, and local residents, engages with recreational facilities and resources. The purpose was to identify the needs, experiences, and barriers to participation in Emory Recreation facilities.

This semester-long project used a mixed methods approach, including a literature review, windshield surveys, key informant interviews, and surveys, to collect both quantitative and qualitative data. The CA team triangulated these data sources to uncover key findings. Those being, persistent issues with facility access and availability, low awareness of recreational resources and group fitness opportunities, insufficient equipment rotation, financial barriers limiting usage, feelings of intimidation or being unwelcome within facility spaces, and notable differences in activity preferences across member types.

These findings highlight critical areas where Emory Recreation and Wellness can focus efforts to improve facility engagement. Limited communication and awareness restrict participation, while physical and financial accessibility issues create real obstacles for many users. Furthermore, the perception of unwelcoming environments and the diversity of preferences among different user groups underscore the need for tailored, inclusive programming and facility management. Lastly, gaps in equipment availability and usage data hinder the ability to respond effectively to member needs and optimize resource allocation.

From these insights, the CA team developed a set of prioritized, evidence-based recommendations designed to address these challenges. These include:

1. Expanding gym hours based on staffing and budgeting constraints.
2. Improving facility cleanliness and locker room updates based on a high feasibility.

3. Updating equipment rotation schedules to ensure a wider and more reliable range of fitness options.
4. Creating more welcoming and inclusive environments through staff training and community-building initiatives.
5. Offering diverse group fitness classes that reflects the varied preferences and needs of students, faculty, staff, and community members.
6. Tailoring programming based on member type.

We hope this assessment provides Emory Recreation and Wellness with actionable insights to strengthen its facilities and programs, enhance engagement, and promote equitable wellness opportunities across the university and surrounding community. By implementing these recommendations in both the short- and long-term, Emory can build a more accessible, inclusive, and responsive recreational environment that supports the well-being of its diverse members.

## Acknowledgements

The Community Assessment team would like to extend our sincere gratitude to the Emory Recreation and Wellness team for their guidance, collaboration, and thoughtful insights throughout this project. We are especially grateful to April Flint, Senior Director of Recreation and Wellness; Alyssa O'Keefe, Associate Director of Recreation and Wellness; Samantha O'Brien, Assistant Director of Athletics & Recreation Operations; Jasmine Gresham, Fitness and Wellness Coordinator; and Oliver Jawornicki, Student Staff, Athlete, and Recreation Participant. Their expertise, support, and willingness to share their perspectives were invaluable in shaping the assessment and ensuring that the findings and recommendations reflect the needs of the Emory community.

We would also like to thank Hayley McMahon, MSPH, CPH, for her instruction, guidance, and mentorship throughout this assessment. Her expertise and encouragement were instrumental in supporting the development, analysis, and presentation of this project.

Finally, we extend our appreciation to our classmates and peers who participated in the Emory Recreation & Wellness Needs & Usage Survey. Their input provided critical insight into facility usage patterns, perceptions, and needs, which were central to the success of this assessment.

## References

Aisch, G., Buchanan, L., Cox, A., & Quealy, K. (2017). *Economic diversity and student outcomes at Emory*. The New York Times. https://www.nytimes.com/interactive/projects/college-mobility/emory-university

Alfred, N. (2025). Influence of Digital Information Resource Dissemination Among Degree Students in College of Education Hong, Adamawa State. 11(2).

ARC. (n.d.). *The Atlanta Region*. ARC. https://atlantaregional.org/about-arc/about-the-atlanta-region/

Bardus, M., Borgi, C., El-Harakeh, M., Gherbal, T., Kharroubi, S., & Fares, E.-J. (2021). Exploring the Use of Mobile and Wearable Technology among University Student Athletes in Lebanon: A Cross-Sectional Study. Sensors (Basel, Switzerland), 21(13), 4472. https://doi.org/10.3390/s21134472

Bian, S., Rupp, A., & Magno, M. (2023). *Fully Automatic Gym Exercises Recording: An IoT Solution*. ResearchGate. https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2305.17594

CDC. (2024, October 29). Benefits of Physical Activity. Physical Activity Basics. https://www.cdc.gov/physical-activity-basics/benefits/index.html

Census Reporter. (n.d.). *Census Profile: State House District 82, GA*. Census Reporter. http://censusreporter.org/profiles/62000US13082-state-house-district-82-ga/

Emory University Recreation & Wellness. (2017). *About Us*. https://recwell.emory.edu/about/index.html

Emory Recreation & Wellness. (2025). Internal membership and utilization data [Unpublished internal data].

Ersöz, Y., Yıldırım, İ., & Zeytun, R. (2023). Investigation of University Students' Recreation Benefit Awareness and Physical Activity Levels. Eurasian Journal of Sport Sciences and Education, 5(2), 158–169. https://doi.org/10.47778/ejsse.1322968

Forrester, S. (2015). Benefits of Collegiate Recreational Sports Participation: Results from the 2013 NASPA Assessment and Knowledge Consortium Study. Recreational Sports Journal, 39(1), 2–15. https://doi.org/10.1123/rsj.2015-0005

Fraccastoro, K. A., Moss, G., Flosi, A., & Karani, K. (2020). Disseminating Information to College Students in a Complex Media Environment. Business Education Innovation Journal, 12(1), 49–53.

Fry, R. (2024). A*re you in the American middle class? Find out with our income calculator.* Pew Research Center. https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2024/09/16/are-you-in-the-american-middle-class/

Hussain, A., Zafar, K., Baig, A. R., Almakki, R., AlSuwaidan, L., & Khan, S. (2022). Sensor Based Gym Physical Exercise Recognition: Data Acquisition and Experiments. Sensors (Basel, Switzerland), 22(7), 2489. https://doi.org/10.3390/s22072489

Kampf, S., Haines, S. G., & Gambino, S. (2018). The Impact of New or Renovated Collegiate Recreation Centers on Recruitment and Retention. Recreational Sports Journal, 42(1),

18–32. https://doi.org/10.1123/rsj.2017-0005
Kim, Y., Wang, Y., & Oh, J. (2016). Digital Media Use and Social Engagement: How Social
Media and Smartphone Use Influence Social Activities of College Students. Cyberpsychology, Behavior and Social Networking, 19(4), 264-269. https://doi.org/10.1089/cyber.2015.0408
Mayers, R., Wilson, A., & Potwarka, L. (2017). *Moderating Effects of Campus Recreation Participation in the Relationship Between Grade Point Average and First-Year Student Engagement: An Exploratory Study* [Journal]. ResearchGate. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/330778329_Moderating_Effects_of_Campus_Recreation_Participation_in_the_Relationship_Between_Grade_Point_Average_and_First-Year_Student_Engagement_An_Exploratory_Study
Office of Institutional Research and Decision Support, Emory University. (n.d.). *Dashboard—Fall Student Enrollment.* Emory University. https://provost.emory.edu/planning-admnistration/data/factbook/enrollment.html
Office of Undergraduate Admission, Emory University. (n.d.). *Directions and details.* Emory University. https://apply.emory.edu/discover/visit/directions.html
Pedragosa, V., Angosto, S., & Gonçalves, C. (2022). Validity and Reliability of a Wearable
Fitness Technology Scale in Portugal. International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health, 19(10), 5927. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph19105927
Phipps, C., Cooper, N., Shores, K., Williams, R., & Mize, N. (2015). Examining the Relationshipbetween Intramural Sports Participation and Sense of Community among College Students. Recreational Sports Journal, 39(2), 105-120. https://doi.org/10.1123/rsj.2015-0041
Rapport, F., Hutchings, H., Doel, M. A., Wells, B., Clement, C., Mellalieu, S., Shubin, S.,
Brown, D., Seah, R., Wright, S., & Sparkes, A. (2018). How Are University Gyms Used by Staff and Students? A Mixed-Method Study Exploring Gym Use, Motivation, and Communication in Three UK Gyms. Societies, 8(1), 15. https://doi.org/10.3390/soc8010015
Riseth, L., Nøst, T. H., Nilsen, T. I. L., & Steinsbekk, A. (2019). Long-term members' use of
fitness centers: A qualitative study. BMC Sports Science, Medicine and Rehabilitation, 11(1), 2. https://doi.org/10.1186/s13102-019-0114-z
U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). *American Community Survey 5-year estimates.* Retrieved from *Census Reporter Profile page for State House District 82, GA.* http://censusreporter.org/profiles/62000US13082-state-house-district-82-ga/
Vasold, K. L., Kosowski, L. E., & Pivarnik, J. M. (2021). Academic Success and 1 Year of
Intramural Sports Participation by Freshmen Students. Journal of College Student Retention: Research, Theory & Practice, 23(2), 383 – 392. https://doi.org/10.1177/151025119833000

WHO. (2024). Physical activity. https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/physical-activity

Wilson, K. E. S., & Millar, P. (2021). Intramural Sport Participation: An Examination of Participant Benefits, Service Quality, Program Satisfaction, and Student Retention. Recreational Sports Journal, 45(2), 149–160. https://doi.org/10.1177/15588661211036906

Wilson, K. E. S., Wood, L., & Snelgrove, R. (2023). If You Build it Will They Come? The Mediating Roles of Human Resource and Program Capacities. *Recreational Sports Journal*, *47*(1), 4–14. https://doi.org/10.1177/15588661221077695

Young, S. J., Ross, C. M., & Barcelona, R. J. (2003). Perceived Constraints by College Students to Participation in Campus Recreational Sports Programs. Recreational Sports Journal, 27(2), 47–62. https://doi.org/10.1123/rsj.27.2.47

Zegre, S. J., Hughes, R. P., Darling, A. M., & Decker, C. R. (2022). The Relationship Between Campus Recreation Facility Use and Retention for First-Time Undergraduate Students. Journal of College Student Retention: Research, Theory & Practice, 24(2), 421–447. https://doi.org/10.1177/1521025120921347

Zou, Y., Liu, S., Guo, S., Zhao, Q., & Cai, Y. (2023). Peer Support and Exercise Adherence in Adolescents: The Chain-Mediated Effects of Self-Efficacy and Self-Regulation. *Children (Basel, Switzerland)*, *10*(2), 401. https://doi.org/10.3390/children10020401

## Appendices

### *Appendix A:* Demographic Characteristics of Emory University & Surrounding Community

***Table A1: Academic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs.***

| Table 1: Academic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs | |
|---|---|
| **Degree-Seeking status** | |
| Degree | 15,494 (96.0%) |
| Non-Degree | 648 (4.0%) |
| **Academic Career** | |
| Undergraduate | 8,374 (51.9%) |
| Postgraduate | 7,768 (48.1%) |
| **Academic Load** | |
| Full-Time | 14,610 (90.5%) |
| Part-Time | 1,532 (9.5%) |
| **Residency** | |
| Domestic | 13,212 (81.8%) |
| International | 2,930 (18.2%) |
| **School** | |
| Allied Health Programs | 534 (3.3%) |
| Candler School of Theology | 422 (2.6%) |
| Emory College of Arts & Sciences | 5,567 (34.5%) |
| Goizueta Business School | 2,319 (14.4%) |
| Laney Graduate School | 2,092 (13.0%) |
| Nell Hodgson Woodruff School of Nursing | 1,393 (8.6%) |
| Oxford College | 967 (6.0%) |
| Rollins School of Public Health | 977 (6.1%) |
| School of Law | 839 (5.2%) |
| School of Medicine | 1,032 (6.4%) |

***Table A2: Demographic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs.***

| Table 2: Demographic details of students enrolled across all schools and programs | |
|---|---|
| **Sex** | |
| Female | 9,719 (60.2%) |
| Male | 6,423 (39.8%) |
| **Age Bands** | |
| Under 18 | 89 (0.6%) |
| 18-24 | 10,551 (65.4%) |
| 25+ | 5,500 (34.1%) |
| **Race/Ethnicity** | |
| American Indian/Alaska Native | 13 (0.1%) |
| Asian | 3,185 (19.7%) |
| Black/African American | 2,227 (13.8%) |
| Hispanic/Latino | 1,550 (9.6%) |
| Native Hawaiian/Other Pacific Islander | 10 (0.1%) |
| Nonresident | 2,930 (18.2%) |
| Race/Ethnicity Unknown | 406 (2.5%) |
| Two or More Races | 616 (3.8%) |
| White | 5,205 (32.2%) |
| **First Generation** | |
| First-generation Undergraduates | 1,210 (7.5%) |
| Non-first-generation undergraduates | 6,616 (41.0%) |
| Unknown Undergraduates | 548 (3.4%) |
| Graduate Students | 7,768 (48.1%) |
| **Historically Underrepresented Groups (HUGS)** | |
| HUGS | 3,800 (23.5%) |
| Non-HUGS | 12,341 (76.5%) |

*Table A3: Demographic details of Emory's community by way of State House District 82.*

| Table 3: Demographic details of Emory's community by way of State House District 82 | |
|---|---|
| **Sex** | |
| Female | 26,006 (45.9%) |
| Male | 30,677 (54.1%) |
| **Age Bands** | |
| Under 18 | 9,983 (17.6%) |
| 18-64 | 38,167 (67.3%) |
| 65+ | 8,533 (15.1%) |
| **Race/Ethnicity** | |
| American Indian/Alaska Native | 74 (0.1%) |
| Asian | 5,554 (9.8%) |
| Black/African American | 8,237 (14.5%) |
| Hispanic/Latino | 4,468 (7.5%) |
| Native Hawaiian/Other Pacific Islander | 2 (0.0%) |
| Other | 49 (0.1%) |
| Two or More Races | 2,782 (4.9%) |
| White | 35,717 (63.0%) |
| **Economics** | |
| Persons below the poverty line | 548 (3.4%) |
| **Household income** | |
| Under $50K | 6,185 (26.2%) |
| $50K - $100K | 5,015 (21.2%) |
| $100K - $200K | 7,185 (30.4%) |
| Over $200K | 5,261 (22.3%) |

## *Appendix B:* Emory Recreation & Wellness Utilization Data

***Figure B1: Student Access to the Woodruff PE Center by Academic Level, Fall 2022–Spring 2025.***

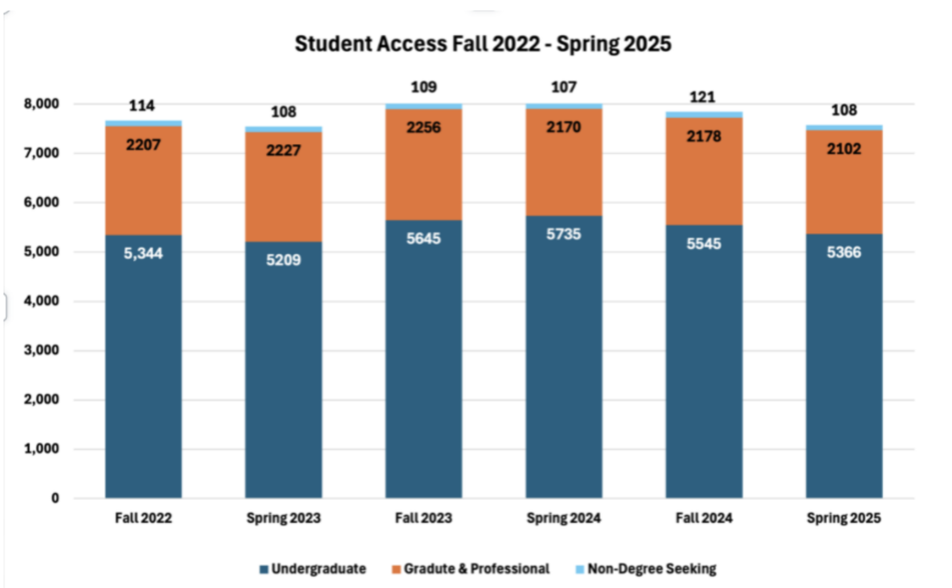
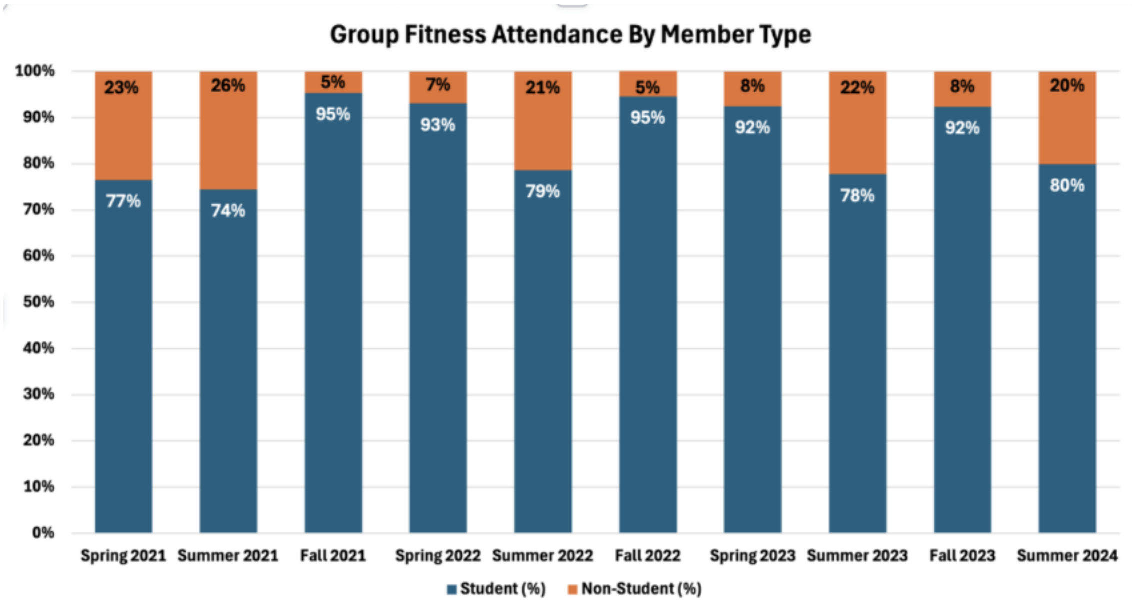
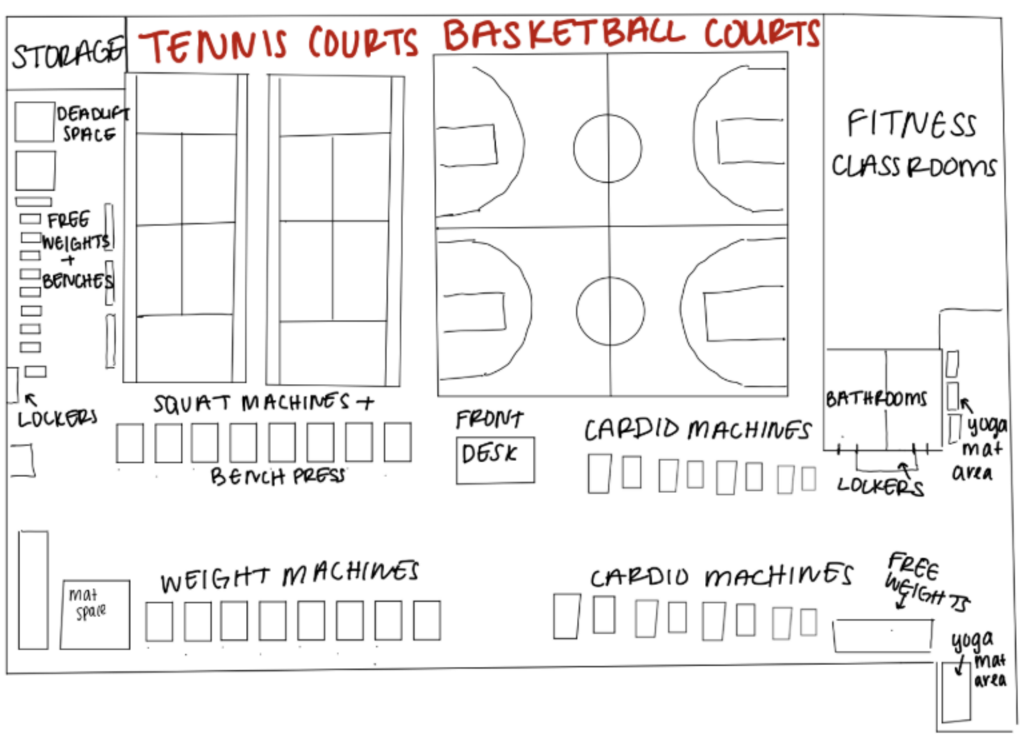


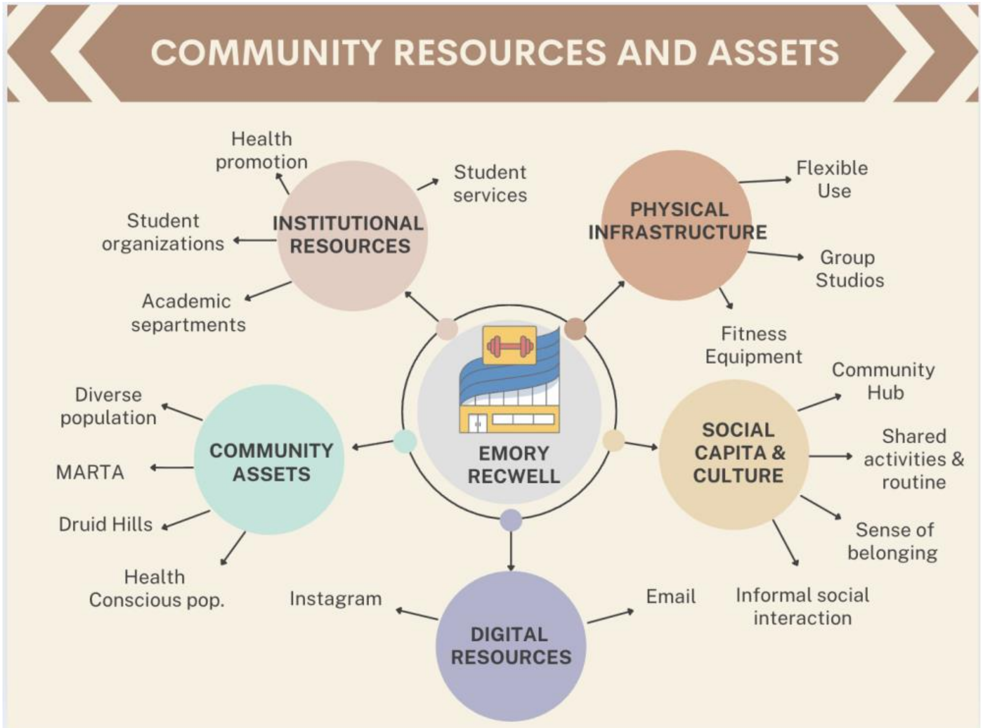
*Figure B2: Group Fitness Attendance by Member Type (Student vs. Non-Student).*



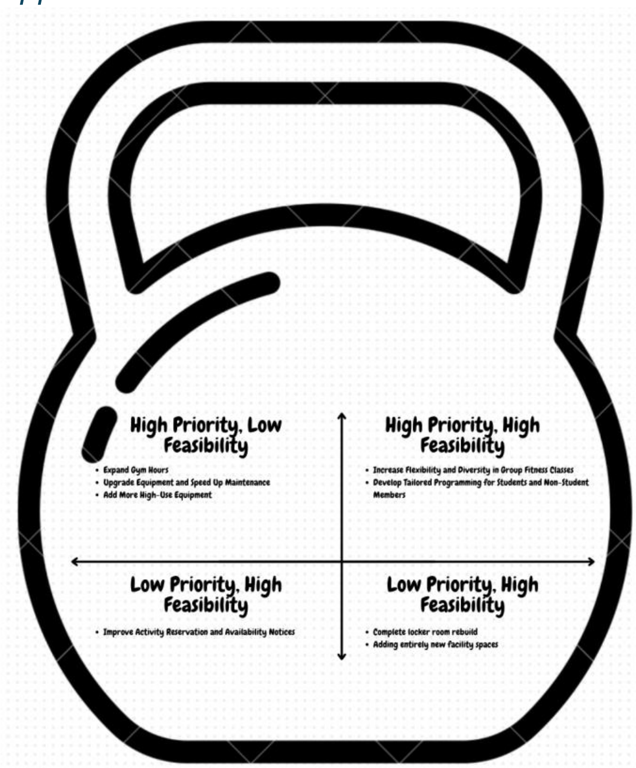

*Appendix C: Diagram of Woodruff PE Center 4th floor*



*Appendix D: Diagram of Community Resources and Assets*




*Appendix E: Priorities Matrix*



## *Appendix F: Key-Informant Interview Guide*

***Introduction/Consent***

Hello, *key informant's name*. My name is *interviewer's name*, and I first want to thank you for taking the time to speak with me today.

I am working alongside a team of graduate students from the Rollins School of Public Health at Emory University to partner with Emory Recreation and Wellness. We hope to assess how Emory Rec services are utilized by students and members, how they might be improved, and awareness of available resources.

Today, we are conducting what is considered a Key Informant Interview. As we mentioned in our initial email, you have been identified as someone who has a well-rounded understanding of Emory's recreational capacities and offerings. The interview should take no longer than 30 minutes to complete and will consist of a number of short questions that aim to gain your perspective – as such, there are no right or wrong answers. Our team will be using this interview, along with other interviews and survey data, to produce recommendations for Emory Recreation and Wellness. Your participation is very important, not only to us, but may very likely contribute to the improvement and expansion of the organization's offerings, structure, and direction.

Before we begin, it is important that you understand that this interview is completely voluntary. We can stop the interview at any time and can skip any questions that you might feel uncomfortable answering. For the purpose of our own clarity and review, we would like to record this interview. The recording will be stored on safe and locked devices and will be deleted after the completion of our assessment. The only individuals who have access to this recording would be the members of our team and our course instructor.

I'm going to ask a series of yes or no questions before we begin the interview to ensure we have your consent to participate:

Do we have your consent to conduct this interview? ( ____YES or ____NO).
Do we have your permission to record this interview? ( ____YES or ____NO).
Do we have your permission to use your name in our report? (____YES or ____NO).
Do you have any questions before we begin?

Thank you for taking the time to participate in this interview. Let's get started.
(Begin recording)

***Warm-Up Questions***

*Rationale: The purpose of this question is to develop rapport with an ice-breaker question that's related to the topic.*

1. What are some ways you like to stay active?

*Rationale: The purpose of these questions is to understand the participant's history and current role at the Rec Well Center.*

2. Tell me about any past or current roles you've had at Emory's Rec Well Center?
    a. What made you want to join the Rec Well team?

*Rational: The purpose of these questions is to understand the participant's perception of the Rec Well Center. Asking the participant for recommendations and hesitations captures things they value about the gym and things they don't.*

3. How would you describe the Rec Well Center to someone who has never been there before?
    a. What are some of your recommendations?
    b. Is there anything that you would be hesitant to recommend? Why or why not?

***Key Question***

Now I want to shift gears a bit and ask a few questions about your experiences at Emory Rec!

*Rationale: The purpose of these questions is to understand the participant's perception of facility and equipment utilization and adequacy.*

1. Of the activities, classes, equipment, etc. that are available at Emory Rec, which ones do you think people use most often?
    a. Why do you think those ones are the most popular?
    b. Which ones aren't utilized as much?
    c. Do you believe that the available resources are adequate to serve the population?

*Rationale: The purpose of these questions is to understand the participant's awareness of members' perceptions, wants, and needs.*

2. What do you think students think about the Emory Rec Well Center?
3. What do you think non-student members think about the Center?
    a. Do you feel the facilities and activities meet student and non-student member needs?
    b. What areas fall short?
    c. What are some strengths?

*Rationale: The purpose of this question is to understand what Rec Well staff perceive to be similarities or differences between student and non-student members, as well as any similarities or differences in their engagement with activities, classes, and equipment.*

4. How would you compare the student members to the non-student members at the Rec Well Center?
    a. What activities, classes, or equipment do you think students gravitate towards?
    b. Which do you think non-students gravitate towards?
    c. Which options are less desirable to students?
    d. What about non-student members?

*Rationale: The purpose of this question is to understand the participant's perceived gaps in programs, activities, and equipment.*

5. What types of programs, activities, and equipment do you wish were available here?
    a. Why do you wish those were here?
    b. How do you think it would enhance the experience/environment at Emory Rec?

*Rationale: The purpose of these questions is to understand the participant's perceived barriers to member engagement and recommended strategies to address them.*

6. What are some barriers you think may stop students and non-student members from engaging with Rec Well facilities and activities?
7. What strategies have been most successful in engaging with the student and community members who are not typically users of the gym?

*Rationale: The purpose of this question is to understand how facility usage changes throughout the year for students and non-students.*

8. How would you describe patterns in facility usage during different parts of the school year, like midterms, finals, or homecoming?
    a. How would you compare those patterns between students and non-student members?

***Closing Questions***

Let's shift to the conversation to the future and talk about some things you'd like to see at the Rec Well Center.

*Rationale: The purpose of these questions is to gauge the participant's recommendations for change. It also shifts the conversation to a high-level discussion to decrease rapport and signal the end of the interview.*

9. If you had unlimited funding and jurisdiction, what changes would you want to make to the WPEC?
10. How do you envision the future of campus wellness services evolving?

Rationale: The purpose of this question is to provide the participant with an opportunity to discuss additional relevant information.

11. Do you have any last comments or thoughts you would like to share with us?

***Conclusion***

Thank you very much for your time. Today we spoke about _(brief 2-4 sentence summary of discussion). Your knowledge and insights will be very helpful to us as we work to improve the functioning and experience of Emory Recreation and Wellness. Thank you again!

## *Appendix G: Primary Data Collection Instrument*

***Introduction***

Hello! We are graduate students attending Rollins School of Public Health, conducting a brief survey on Emory Recreation and Wellness, to better understand facility usage and engagement with programs and services.

Participation in this survey is voluntary, and your responses will remain anonymous. This survey should take about five minutes to complete. You may skip any questions you do not wish to answer. By proceeding, you consent to participate in this project. Thank you for your time and contribution to improving Emory Recreation and Wellness! If you have any questions about this project, please contact Amy Hunt at amy.hunt2@emory.edu.

***Survey Questions***

**Please answer the following questions based on your current experience with the Emory Recreation and Wellness Center.**

Q1: Which best describes you? (Select one: Emory student, Emory University employee, Emory Healthcare employee, Emory retiree, Emory affiliate, Community member, other)

*Rationale: This question allows us to identify respondents by their relationship to Emory (student, faculty/staff or community member) to compare differences in facility usage, engagement patterns, group fitness and needs in these populations. It helps us keep our focus on the differences between students and non-students experience in the Recreational Centers available at Emory.*

Q2: How often do you visit the Emory recreation facilities in a typical week? (0, 1-2. 3-4, 5-7 times per week)

*Rationale: This question allows us to measure the frequency of facility use between the different gym user populations. Comparing usage across groups can reveal engagement barriers, peak times and resource allocation needs.*

Q3: Which facility do you use? (Please select one: Woodruff P.E. Center (WPEC), Student Activity and Academic Center (SAAC), both, neither)

Q4: What types of activities do you usually participate in at the fitness facilities? (Select all that apply: weight training, cardio, group fitness, team sports, aquatics, climbing wall, tennis, racquetball/squash, open recreation (i.e. basketball, badminton, track), other, don’t know/prefer not to answer)

*Rationale: This allows us to determine the level of engagement across the types of activities utilized in the center. It also helps inform resource allocation, space planning, and programming priorities. It also provides insight into the overall utilization of group fitness classes.*

Q5: What motivates you to participate in activities or programs at Emory Rec and Wellness? (Select all that apply: physical health, mental health, social interaction, stress relief, accountability, enjoyment, other)

*Rationale: Answers to this question could help us identify what is most important for users to encourage their usage of all varieties of programs and classes. Understanding what drives participants (health, accountability, social connection) can help identify potential gaps in programming and shaping future strategies*

Q6: What barriers, if any, prevent you from accessing or participating in Emory Rec & Wellness facilities or programs? (select all that apply: cost of membership, awareness, transportation, intimidation, lack of time, feeling unwelcome, accessibility issues, personal motivation, other).

*Rationale: This identifies structural and personal barriers to access, expanding literature and stakeholder insights about equity and inclusion. Findings will help guide strategies to improve accessibility and participation for all members of the Emory community.*

Q7: How satisfied are you with current offerings at Emory Recreation and Wellness facilities (Extremely dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, neither satisfied nor dissatisfied, somewhat satisfied, extremely satisfied)

*Rationale: Helps us evaluate overall satisfaction and how well the current offerings meet user expectations. This will help identify gaps and areas for improvement*

Q7: What improvements or additional offerings would make you more likely to participate in Emory Recreation and Wellness programs or activities? (open-ended)

*Rationale: This open-ended prompt allows us to gather qualitative insight into unmet needs and user preferences, which can guide actionable recommendations.*

Q8: How did you first find out about Emory Recreation and Wellness resources, activities, and events? (select all that apply: email newsletters or announcements, social media, friends, classmates, or colleagues, flyers, posters, or digital screens on campus, Emory Recreation and Wellness' website, The Hub @ Emory, I don't usually find out about resources, activities, or events, other)

*Rationale: This question assesses how participants learn about Emory Rec Programs, which will help evaluate the effectiveness of the current outreach methods of the gym as well as provide information on improvements for future communication strategies to increase engagement.*

Q9: Is there any additional information that you'd like to share about your engagement with Emory Recreation and Wellness facilities and programs? (open-ended)

*Rationale: Allows participants to provide context or perspective not captured by structured questions.*

Q10: If you'd like to be entered in a raffle to win either an Intramural Play Pass or InBody Body Composition analysis, please enter your email address. Five winners will be chosen! (Open-ended: Small text box for email address)

*Rationale: to provide information on participants if they choose to be entered into the incentive raffle.*

Thank you for participating in this survey. Your time and responses mean a lot to us!

## Appendix H: Data Triangulation Table

*Table 1: Data Triangulation Table*

| | Literature Review | Secondary Data | Windshield Survey | Asset Mapping | Key-Informant Interviews | Primary Data Collection - Survey |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| [Key Finding 1] Facility Access & Availability Issues (Hours & Crowding) | "Recreational facilities must ensure accessible environments and adequate space; insufficient access reduces engagement (Riseth et al., 2019)." | Undergraduate student usage of facilities: 83% (Spring 2024), 82% (Fall 2024), 82% (Spring 2025)<br><br>Graduate student usage of facilities: 16% (Spring 2024), 16% (Fall 2024), 16% (Spring 2025)<br><br>Non-degree seeking usage of facilities: 1% (Spring 2024), 1% (Fall 2024), 1% (Spring 2025) | "The energy began to increase as students ended classes and filed into WPEC"<br><br>"[gym users] shoved backpacks into lockers and crowded the bathroom areas"<br><br>"[At 5:00 PM] it was noticeably busier than during my midday visit on Wednesday. Students poured in through the gates... The atmosphere felt electric, fast-paced, and extremely chaotic... the stretching and mat area, which was quiet earlier in the week, was now crowded." | Ample student employees could provide options for increased facility hours<br><br>Potential for improved use of space with rearranging of current equipment | Sam: "Popular equipment (basketballs, day lockers) get heavy use; racquetball & sand volleyball remain underutilized."<br><br>Jasmine: "And so I wouldn't say, I would be hesitant to recommend, but I would say, like, either a new gym user, or just as someone who just may not enjoy being in like a super crowded environment, because at peak time it gets really overstimulating," | Survey Q6: Lack of time (46%), overcrowding (7%), and reduced availability negatively impact use ; "Lack of time" identified as the primary barrier for students, reported by 62.3% of students vs 32.2% of paying members ($p<0.001$), connecting directly to findings in Q8 and Q10 about extended hours<br><br>Survey Q7: Satisfaction moderate (mean = 3.36/5).<br><br>Survey Q8: Emerging themes about extended facility hours especially during the evening, weekend, and breaks<br><br>Survey Q10: Emerging themes about lack of open spots, spaces, and requests for extended facility hours |
| [Key Finding 2] Low Awareness of Recreational Resources & Group Fitness | "Universities often struggle with promoting awareness of recreational offerings; visibility of programs is essential to increasing | Group fitness participation (student): 80% in Summer 2024, 92% in Fall 2023<br><br>Group fitness participation (non- | "Although the gym was quite busy, the first floor offered a more relaxed and slower paced environment" - indicates that potential lack of | Participants must enter the gym using 1 of 2 entrances; marketing of gym resources could be made more readily visible and available to users | Jasmine: "Many people do not know about lesser-known facilities (e.g., rock walls, multiple floors) -"people don't | Survey Q6: 5% of users report lack of awareness as a barrier to usage, though awareness as a barrier shows |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Opportunitie s | participation (Phipps et al., 2015; Forrester, 2015)."<br><br>"In a study assessing constraints that students face pertaining to recreational activity, one of the primary barriers to access was a lack of knowledge or awareness of what was available to the student population. (Young et al., 2003)."<br><br>"Students prefer communication from their academic institutions to be facilitated through email (57.2% of respondents), followed by informational posts on Instagram (39.7% of respondents)." | student): 20% in Summer 2024, 8% in Fall 2023 | knowledge about resources and equipment on first floor leads to decreased usage | utilizing already existing media elements and student helpdesks | even know there are four floors". ; "We've actually seen like, an uptick in, like, the amount of non-student members who are participating, at least fitness classes"<br><br>Sam: "Many classes fill up, but some activities like racquetball are unused due to low visibility." ; "Our students are more likely to use the programs offered than paying members, because the paying members just are coming to use… well, they're coming to use the track, they're coming to use the fitness equipment... Generally, I'm generalizing, but they don't generally have a membership to participate in group fitness classes. They don't have a membership to participate in intramurals and club sports, or things like that. So, I do think the programs are more geared towards students" | NO significant difference between groups (4.1% students vs 5.9% paying members, p=0.65)<br><br>Survey Q8: Emerging themes about reported lack of diverse group fitness opportunities<br><br>Survey Q9:Only 13% of users learn about Rec services through the website and only 29% through email. 10% report they "don't usually find out" about resources. Q Low awareness is a documented barrier (3.5%).<br><br>Survey Q10: Reports of inadequate communicatio n and advertising about group fitness offerings<br><br>Survey Q10: Emerging themes about notices and communicatio n of facility schedule |
| [ Key Finding 3] Lack of equipment in rotation | "Among first year students 84.5% to 91.7% reported that student recreational facility resources had some level of importance in their decision to attend the facility and | N/A | "The cardio machines along the walls on the right side of the gym were completely full. There were rows of treadmills, ellipticals, and bikes all in use." | Increas ing community awareness of recreational resources would inform gym users of equipment on the first floor of the WPEC and of the SAAC | Sam : "Um, I would say, in terms of resources and facility space, it's generally adequate. For Pickleball, ultimately, no... because so | Sur vey Q4: 58.6% of respondents report primarily utilizing the weight room at Emory facilities, indicating that |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 89.4% to 92.5% of students reported that it influenced their retention (Kampf et al., 2018)." | | | | many of our students play it, we actually don't have enough pickleball courts... We're making the most with the space that we have, so… I would say in terms of the amount of equipment we have, I'm sure we're fine I think our setup could probably be, um, optimized a little bit more to help the students, um, and so in that way, I would say, if we're inadequate."<br><br>Jasmine: "We have all the equipment you would need for a full workout, but less people."; "non-student members usually complain about student use on machines."<br><br>Olivier: "A lot of students just want to weightlift, or they want to participate in some classes for PE because they're required to. And paying members often have plus one membership, like they don't come alone most of the time. So, I think they're there to be at the gym with someone or to get personal training." This indicates that there is a potential influx | this is a highly relevant finding<br><br>Survey Q7: 14.3% of survey respondents report feeling somewhat dissatisfied with current facility offerings<br><br>Survey Q8: Emerging themes about lack of equipment (specifically squat racks, cable machines, and lower body equipment), and inability to utilize equipment due to overcrowding in recreational spaces |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | of non-student gym participants bringing plus-ones, potentially necessitating more equipment. | |
| [ Key Finding 4] Financial barriers to usage of recreational facilities and resources | "Costs of gym memberships results in lack of accessiblity due to financial constraints amongst adult populations (Khalid & Shah, 2024)." | N/A | N/A | Cost of day-passes remains relatively low for guests of gym users | Sam and Jasmine mentioned more frequent reports of dissatisfaction with recreational resources, cleanliness, and equipment function amongst non-student members, citing it to be likely due to their position as paying members. | Survey Q6: Cost of membership (11.3%) was documented as a barrier to access or participation; Cost is reported as a barrier by 17.8% of students vs only 4.8% of non-student paying members ($p<0.001$)<br><br>Survey Q8: Emerging themes about parking prices and paying for both SAAC and WPEC access<br><br>Survey Q10: User reports related to prorating membership fees during holiday-related facility closures; Emerging themes regarding free parking or providing parking waivers when utilizing gym facilities |
| [ Key Finding 5] Feeling unwelcome or intimidated in recreational facility spaces | "Facility spaces were often gendered, multifunctional, used for stress relief and sometimes intimidating (Rapport et al., 2018). Rieth et al. (2019) found that social and environmental support is a key | N/A | "As I walked up from the stairs into the gym space, the student at the front desk barely looked up from his laptop to greet me."<br><br>"Even neutral spaces like this can be [socially | Employees on the floor are largely students, potentially allowing for more comfortable conversation to be had amongst student user population | Sam: "Um, typically, college fitness floors, um, are a little bit bigger to be a little bit more welcoming and environment."; "Going to the gym is kind of, like, intimidating, | Survey Q6: Feeling unwelcome (5%) and intimidated (8.3%) are documented barriers to usage; Intimidation is reported by 15.8% of students vs |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | contributor to long term engagement at facilities and places importance on factors like facility cleanliness and staff friendliness." | | coded], particularly when performance, strength, and appearance are silently on display." | | um… like, very intimidating if you don't know… Because you go to the gym, you're like, okay, like, I'm now, like, this is my fitness goal, but, like, how do I achieve that?"<br><br>Jasmine: "We've gotten feedback in the past that just the way that our building is constructed, especially the fourth-floor fitness area, our main fitness area. It can be kind of intimidating, because it's built like a catwalk. So like, it feels like all eyes are kind of on you, yeah, like the whole time you don't really have like a space to yourself..." ; "a larger learning curve when you take things away and put new things with our non-student members"<br><br>Olivier: "Paying patrons that aren't students may not feel too comfortable with like going to the rock wall because they think it's for students. But we have some people like that who do that. But I would say that everyone feels pretty comfortable with the things they do." | only 1.3% of non-student paying members ($p<0.001$), indicating students are 12x more likely to report feeling intimidated |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| [ Key Finding 6] Activity Preferences Differ Substantially by Member Type | "Among first year students 84.5% to 91.7% reported that student recreational facility resources had some level of importance in their decision to attend the facility and 89.4% to 92.5% of students reported that it influenced their retention (Kampf et al., 2018)." | Undergraduate student usage of facilities: 83% (Spring 2024), 82% (Fall 2024), 82% (Spring 2025)<br><br>Graduate student usage of facilities: 16% (Spring 2024), 16% (Fall 2024), 16% (Spring 2025)<br><br>Non-degree seeking usage of facilities: 1% (Spring 2024), 1% (Fall 2024), 1% (Spring 2025) | Different activity spaces utilized at different times throughout the day<br><br>Peak times show different activity concentrations | Students prefer team sports and flexible activities<br><br>Paying members heavily utilize aquatics facilities<br><br>Equipment needs differ substantially between groups | Sam: "Many classes fill up, but some activities like racquetball are unused due to low visibility." ; "Our students are more likely to use the programs offered than paying members, because the paying members just are coming to use… well, they're coming to use the track, they're coming to use the fitness equipment... Generally, I'm generalizing, but they don't generally have a membership to participate in group fitness classes. They don't have a membership to participate in intramurals and club sports, or things like that. So, I do think the programs are more geared towards students,"<br><br>Olivier: "a lot of students just want to weightlift, or they want to participate in some classes for PE because they're required to. And paying members often have plus one membership, like they don't come alone most of the time. So, I think they're there to be at the gym with someone or to get personal training." | Survey Q4: Team Sports - 12.3% of students vs 1.3% of paying members ($p<0.001$)<br><br>Survey Q4: Aquatics - 8.9% of students vs 41.4% of paying members ($p<0.001$)<br><br>Survey Q4: Cardio - 45.2% of students vs 32.2% of paying members ($p<0.05$)<br><br>Students prefer quick, flexible, social activities (team sports, cardio)<br><br>Paying members prefer structured, individual fitness activities (aquatics, weight training)<br><br>Weight training is popular across both groups (64.4% students vs 55.9% paying, $p=0.17$ - not significant) |